

# HAZARD NAVIGATOR



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## **Preface**

None. I'm still writing this, how could it possibly be prefaced?

# 1. Game Basics

## Introduction

Hazard Navigator is a TTRPG ruleset that takes a holistic approach to running an RPG game. Fundamentally, the game comprises of several players, who will be in control of one or more Player Characters (PCs). The game master (GM) presents scenarios for the players to navigate, which players are encouraged to interact with in order to manufacture outcomes.

The GM will require knowledge of the entirety of this ruleset to apply it wholly but may choose to omit certain aspects depending on the type of game they run. For example, a game focussed on social interaction and political intrigue may not benefit from the full scope of the combat rules, and vice versa. Games that comprise a little of everything should find tools to address all aspects within this ruleset, however.

Determining the success or failure of an outcome is done via checks. Players are given various mechanics to alter the likelihood and severity of outcomes, and must use these mechanics in order to navigate the scenarios and survive the various hazards and obstacles the GM puts in their path.

## The Fiction & the Rules

The game will typically exist within a fictional world and present a form of narrative for the players to interact with. This fiction has an internal logic that the GM will have some knowledge of, though even for a well-prepared GM it is difficult to have complete knowledge of an entire fictional world. It is more important that there be a consistent internal logic, as this ensures that the fiction responds to players and provides them with consequences for actions and opportunities to interact with it.

The rules, by contrast, are a series of mechanics designed to simulate this fiction. They aim to present a consistent means of allowing the players and GM to interact with the fiction, allow for the generation of outcomes to uncertain events, and enable both players and GMs to construct reasonable expectations for consequences. The rules therefore are not the internal logic of the setting and fiction, however can serve as an abstraction for players to interact with it.

## Scenarios & Scenes

The scenarios the GM presents are divided into Scenes. **A scene is a means of book-ended a portion of gameplay.** At its most basic level, a Scene is a portion of the game where something ‘happens’; this may be a combat encounter, overcoming an obstacle during exploration, reaching a destination after a long trip, finishing a social encounter, or completing a minor recuperation. The completion of a scene is tracked by the GM.

The GM does not need to have prior knowledge of what every scene in a scenario must be; many scenes will occur organically during the game. However, as it is important for tracking the progression of events and some mechanics, knowing when to end a scene is mechanically significant. Ending a scene can be done:

- By the GM unilaterally, when the conclusion of a book-ended sequence of events
- By agreement with the players in instances where the division of events is not immediately clear.

It is recommended to clearly signpost when a scene ends to players by saying ‘**end scene**’.

## Queries

Hazard Navigator has several mechanics that involve asking questions to players, and using the answer to determine the outcome. These will appear bolded in the document.

These are called **queries**. Queries are used to allow for player input in the scenario. They are intended to allow for players to explore their character and the story that they are experiencing. For the GM queries can be used to probe the players for ways to make the game more exciting and tense (such as by asking for what a player character fears the most).

The game benefits from both parties being honest and engaged in exploring new options in the moment, and discover things about the characters. Once a query is answered by a player character, this is taken to reflect the reality of the situation within the fiction **for that character** (unless the answer directly contradicts the internal logic of the fiction).

Queries will frequently offer an alternative option (such as increasing stress) for when either a player would rather postpone these moments or the answers provided simply do not make sense for the moment in question, or would be less impactful.

## Game Preparation

### *Players*

Players will require an understanding of the basic rules (from page 10 to 28) as well as a character rules and class rules (see Character Creation on page 29). The GM may request further preparation if required by the scenario.

For games with frequent combat encounters, understanding the combat rules and injuries system will also be beneficial (see Combat Rules and Injuries & Recovery).

### *GM*

The GM should have a prepared list of the major non-player characters they want to run and have their relevant abilities and modifiers ready. A list of relevant simplified characters (described in Non-Player Characters) will also help round out the required cast.

The majority of the game does not require miniatures or a table and can be played completely verbally, however combat benefits from being played on a grid, especially when including multiple combatants in a region where space and distance are expected to become relevant.

## General Guidelines

- Always **round up** when a fraction is involved.
- When outlining outcomes and checks, simple, direct statements are preferable over ambiguous, run-on sentences.
- In instances where an outcome is **ambiguous** or not adequately covered by the rules, a coin-flip can settle most outcomes **once distilled to 2 distinct options**.
- Bonuses from the same source do not stack with themselves unless specified otherwise.
- If it is cooler to ignore the rules, this can be accommodated upon **mutual agreement of all involved parties**; the justification for such a deviation is that **it shall be sick as hell**.

## 2. Actions, Order of Operations & Opportunities

There is no limit to the types of action that a player character can make, since fundamentally every action a character takes is determined by how the player phrases the course of action that they want the character to take. However, in general, it can be said that every action taken by a character will feature a dominant verb, whether the character is in combat, navigating a social encounter, or exploring a forbidden landscape.

Actions require **opportunities**. Actions are taken by the player taking an opportunity and phrasing their character's action. An action, clearly phrased, will feature one or more dominant **verbs**. Additional conditional terms may be added which specify an order of operation, or additional requirements. For example:

*I would like to **force** open the door.*

*Moirag **moves** to the safe zone whilst **avoiding** the traps.*

*Can I **interpret** the symbols on the wall?*

In combat, there are specific **combat actions** that are described in the Basic Combat Actions, however they also operate by the same principle. Each action can be taken by taking an **opportunity**. In combat these are represented by Opportunity Points. Outside of combat, opportunities are handled differently in order to enable more flexible and free-flowing decisions.

Actions in combat are covered in the Combat Rules.

Actions in general are covered below.

### *Basic Actions*

In order to take an action, the character must be able to take the **opportunity** to do so.

**Actions can have primarily 3 outcomes:**

- Gaining an outcome with a tangible effect  
*Note: actions that do not result in a tangible effect, that is to say, a change in circumstance that can realistically affect the situation the characters are in may not necessitate an action*
- Providing advantage or disadvantage for checks related to the action
- Empowering or reducing an effect as part of an outcome  
*Note: this may involve increasing the severity of a harm, or by increasing the positive effects of a different action*

Actions are limited by the internal logic of the fiction. Abilities and features may expand on what a character can logically do within the fiction.

### *Order of Operation*

Actions are solved in 2 turns; the Player's turn, and the GM's turn.

If the players are **initiating** an event or are **driving** an encounter, then the players take their turn first. Non-player characters, monsters, and environmental effects will occur on the GM's turn.

If an **external force** initiates an event instead, or a **non-player character** or **monster**, then the GM takes their turn first, will resolve any necessary outcomes and describe events, and then allow the players to take their actions.

If the order of operations is unclear, then the order is determined by a 50/50 coin flip.

### *Players' Turn*

Players can decide in what order their actions take place in within their turn. Any disputes, such as in the event of characters trying to take an action before another, can resolve the order of operations using contested checks, as described in Contests, mediated by the GM as normal.

**In combat encounters, the players will choose their order of operations at the start of combat and maintain that order for the remainder of the combat encounter.** They may alter the order at the start of their turn provided unanimous agreement is reached.

### *GM's Turn*

On the GM's turn, it is convenient to organise events taken by entities and the environment other than the players in the following order:

1. Environmental effects (such as weather, traps, or other phenomenon)
2. Living entities hostile to the players
3. Living entities friendly to the players
4. Living entities neutral to the players

### *Consequence*

Fundamentally, all actions taken should have a clear indication of what the immediate consequence of the action should be. **An action without consequence will not necessitate an opportunity in most cases.** Whilst the long-term consequences of an action may be unknown to players, the immediate outcome of an action should be made clear before rolling any checks.

Once the consequences are established, the outcome of the action can be determined; that is to say, whether it was successful or not, or led to the intended outcome or not.

### *Success & Failure*

If the action is determined to succeed by any means, the intended outcome of the action occurs, although the GM is at liberty to contextualise and interpret the logical consequences of what a success might mean depending on the situation.

For example, if a character successfully opens a locked door, the door will open, however what is behind the door is at the discretion of the GM based on the scenario. Alternatively, a character may successfully cause a non-player character to choose to take an action based on what the player says, but it is still up to the GM to determine how the non-player character does this within the bounds of logic.

In the event of a failure, a failure may be **total** (all aspects of the action failed to net the intended result) or **partial**. Particularly in the case of complex actions (see Complexity), the GM is at liberty to determine if every aspect of the check failed, or if only certain aspects failed.

Alternatives to a check completely failing might also be that an action:

- Succeeds, but takes significantly longer
- Succeeds, but at an unforeseen cost
- Only yields partial results (such as only taking half of a secret document as opposed to the full thing)

*Note: A complete failure results in a slow-down of the game. This can be effective to prompt players to re-strategize but can also slow the momentum that players have and extend game time. It is up to the GM to determine when a partial or complete failure is both logical within the fiction, and appropriate for the game.*

## *Opportunities & Restriction*

Outside of combat, there are three general states relating to whether characters have the opportunity to take an action or not, and how many.

- **Free Opportunity:** There are no restrictions placed on the characters. They are not constrained by time or any other external influence. Characters, on the players turn, can take as many actions as their characters would realistically be able to based on the internal logic of the game.
- **Normal:** The characters are restricted by time to a moderate degree, but there are no significant external forces preventing them from taking actions. On the players turn, each player can take a single action.

By default, creating an opportunity will mean having a -1 disadvantage (described in Advantages and Disadvantages) on any subsequent action taken by the character, **unless** the character chooses to create an opportunity for another character to use; in which case, no disadvantage is **automatically due** to the creation of the opportunity.

## *Interruptions*

On the GM's turn, it is possible for players, in some circumstances, to **interrupt** an event that happens on the GM's turn. In the fiction, this represents a character reacting quickly to something. This is done at a cost, as it is harder to interrupt an event than it is to wait for an **opportunity** normally.

If a player wishes to attempt this, they must be logically able to do so; they cannot do so if they are restrained or otherwise restricted physically.

The player must describe what they do to **create the opportunity** to interrupt the event. In addition, whatever subsequent action they take is done at -1 disadvantage.

If the character is in a Normal state, they **forfeit their subsequent turn**. If the character is in a Free state, then they do not forfeit their subsequent turn.

**Example of a Free Opportunity state:** The characters are at a campsite preparing for a mission. They do not have a meaningful time limit and can readily multitask.

The characters are on a long journey; there is ample time in the day to do various things, as the scene takes place over a long duration.

**Example of a Normal state:** The characters are operating in opposition to another group. They must be tactical with their actions.

The characters are in a dangerous environment and are physically restricted; they must be careful with their every action.

The characters are pressed in a crowd; the crowd is actively hampering their ability to move and take action.

## Scale

In general, when not in combat or positioned on a grid, it is not convenient to refer to distances in terms of metres, but to instead use qualitative descriptors. However, when on a grid specific measurements become more helpful to determine character positioning.

The following table can help convert between abstract and discrete scales.

| Distance      | Abstract / Narrative Distance                                                                | Discrete     |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Close Range   | Within touchable distance / Whisper/indoor voice audible                                     | 2 metres     |
| Short Range   | Across a room or down a corridor / Projecting voice                                          | 20 metres    |
| Medium Range  | Down a street or between buildings / Shouting distance                                       | 50 metres    |
| Long Range    | Within a town / Within a forest / Within a valley / Between ships / Barely audible bellowing | 500 metres   |
| Extreme Range | Anywhere within the scene / Echo of loud noises only                                         | 5 kilometres |

In general, when outside of combat, abstract distances are preferred, as it is not realistically feasible for the GM or player to know the metric measurements of every valley and corridor they encounter.

Discrete measurements are preferred for grid-based combat.

## Movement

Movement is unique in that it is both an action and implied as part of an action. What this means is that a player may choose to move their character from A to B as an action, but in the case of many actions, small movements are also included as part of other actions, such as opening a door or shoving an opponent.

**When on foot, outside of combat and in a Normal State**, it takes an Opportunity to move at an unhurried pace (such as walking or strolling) a short range. Alternatively, a character can use an Opportunity to move at speed (such as running or sprinting), they can move a medium range. Any movement done in close range can be implied as part of another action. Alternate modes of transport, such as horses, automobiles, and flying vehicles, may permit faster movement as an opportunity in Normal States.

Long and extreme ranges can be moved as an Opportunity in Free Opportunity states unless another restriction applies. The maximum distance travelled as part of an opportunity should be roughly proportional to the time it would take for other characters to perform their own actions.

In Free Opportunity states, alternate forms of transport are considered in terms of movement relative to one another; that is to say, an automobile on a road is faster than a horse, therefore in the fiction the automobile would reach their destination before the horse in most cases.

Movement in combat is covered in Combat Movement (page 65).

### 3. Determining Outcomes

#### Checks Basics

##### *Basics*

Determining outcomes in Hazard Navigator is done (most often) by making **checks**. Checks are instances where in order to identify whether an outcome happens or not, dice are rolled in order to resolve the uncertainty. In Hazard Navigator, three six-sided dice are used (3d6; a single six-sided dice is referred to as a d6). The act of rolling to resolve an outcome is referred to as a check.

An outcome occurs if the sum of the dice (referred to as score) reaches a certain amount.

**Hazard Navigator assumes that when the outcome of a single, simple event is uncertain, there is a 50% chance that it succeeds, and a 50% chance that it fails.**

The score to beat is always 11 on 3d6 (that is to say, the total sum of the dice must be either 11 or a higher number). This represents a 50% chance of failure, and a 50% chance of success. It is, in essence, a coin flip.

Checks are not required when the outcome is **certain**; they are for when the occurrence of an outcome is not known or realistically predetermined. For example, there is no realistic way for a character to fail to open an unlocked door.

In general, if an action has no meaningful **consequence** if it fails or passes, it can be easier to assume that a check passes by default unless it is illogical within the context of the fiction.

##### *Advantages and Disadvantages*

Checks can have both **advantage** and **disadvantage**. Having a +1 advantage means that instead of rolling 3d6, you roll an additional dice and discard the **lowest** number rolled. Having -1 disadvantage means that an additional dice is also rolled, but the **highest** number rolled is discarded.

Advantage and disadvantages can stack; having a total of +2 advantage means two extra dice are rolled and the two lowest numbers discarded, and +3 means three extra dice are rolled. Similarly, -2 disadvantage means that the two highest scores are discarded. A -1 disadvantage also cancels out a +1 advantage. When all advantages and disadvantages cancel out, the roll is done as normal.

**Advantages and disadvantages, when summed together, cannot go above +3 or go below -3, for any reason.**

Advantages can be gained by using abilities, or performing a check in advantageous circumstances (for example, if there is a factor that is actively assisting the outcome. Disadvantages can similarly be imposed on most checks using abilities, but also as a result of the check **complexity**.

##### *Complexity*

Some outcomes require more complex sequences of events to occur either simultaneously or in sequence. A check becomes more complex when, in order to describe the sequence of events that needs to happen, additional **conditional terms** are added. These include, but may not be limited to:

WHILST, AND, WITHOUT



The above may include synonyms thereof. Some examples include:

*Pick the locked door, **without** alerting the nearby guards.*

*Break open the safe **whilst** fighting **without** triggering the traps.*

*Operate an unknown device **whilst** running.*

*Persuade the noblewoman to agree to a request **whilst** appearing more professional than you are and **without** being noticed by her advisor.*

*In addition, when an outcome has more than one **prerequisite** for success, the complexity also increases when that prerequisite occurring is included as part of the check.*

In simple terms; when a check requires multiple things to go right in order for the outcome to occur, the complexity increases. Note: prerequisites and conditional terms should be used for when the inclusion of these terms meaningfully changes the context of the outcome.

For every additional **prerequisite** and **conditional term** used to describe the check, the check has a -1 disadvantage.

## *Modifiers*

Modifiers can come from various sources such as a characters' Character Scores, Skills, Abilities, and other effects. Modifiers are added (and subtracted) from the sum rolled.

For example: if on 3d6 the sum is 10, but a +2 modifier is applied, then the resulting score is 12; this is a success.

Modifiers from all sources are summed. For example, if a character has +2 from a skill, but -1 from a temporary malus such as an injury,

**Modifiers cannot exceed +5 or go below -5, from any source.**

## *Making Checks*

Depending on whether a check requires input from a character or not determines who rolls for checks. When an outcome requires meaningful action and input from a character, the person responsible for that character (either a player or the GM, in the case of non-player characters) rolls the check. These are referred to as **Burden of Success (BoS)** checks (that is to say, the burden of succeeding an action lies with the character making the check).

If instead a check is rolled to determine whether something goes wrong in a way that is not due to intentional character action, the GM rolls instead. These are referred to **Burden of Failure (BoF)** checks (that is to say, the burden of causing a failure lies with factors largely beyond the characters control).

## Severity

Severity is a concept referred to frequently throughout Hazard Navigator. If checks, along with advantages/disadvantages and modifiers are used to determine the relative likelihood of outcomes, **severity** determines the degree of **harm** that results from an outcome.

Severity **only** applies to outcomes that deliver harm to a character or non-player character.

**Any outcome that can deliver meaningful harm to a subject is assumed by default to have a severity level of 1.**

Harm can take many forms, but the degree of severity is used to compare and rank different outcomes with harms relative to one another. There are 4 severity levels from 1 to 4; a severity level of 0 constitutes no harm, meaning there is no negative effect.

In general, harm is tracked using Injury Points (IP).

**Unless otherwise specified, the number of IP an outcome delivers are equal to the Severity of the outcome.**

For example: *A severity 2 (S2) cut with a sabre causes the target to gain 2 IP.*

*A fall led to a bad landing with a severity of 1. This caused the individual to gain 1 IP.*

Injury points are tracked by the character in question, or the GM in the case of non-player characters.

There are mechanics that exist to exacerbate or mitigate the severity of outcomes, described in later sections.

## Volatility

Volatility is a measure of how unpredictable a situation is. In theory, any situation has determined factors that are all accounted for that allow for a reliable estimation of likelihood, as per the Checks rules above. In practice, many situations are chaotic, confusing, and may have far-reaching consequences beyond the immediate environment.

There are three levels of volatility. A situation with **no volatility** means that the outcome is predetermined and known; no check is needed. A situation that is **unknown, but has all major factors accounted for** is resolved using the checks rules above. A situation where all factors cannot be reliably determined before making the check is considered **volatile**.

When a check is volatile, **rolls of a double 1 or double 6** on the check mean that a **volatile effect** has occurred. This may change the outcome of the check substantially.

When a volatile effect occurs, the GM or player will roll on the following table and apply the following effects. Where a choice needs to be made to determine the effect, the person responsible for the check (as in, the player responsible for the player character, or GM for non-player characters) makes the decision.

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The outcome automatically fails, and in spectacular fashion. An Adverse event occurs or is progressed, if applicable.<br><br>Adverse events only occur on burden of success checks.                                                                                                                                |
| 2 | If the check passed, subtract 1d6 from the score OR, if the check would result in a harm with a severity score of 2 or higher, reduce the Severity by 1.<br><br>If the check failed, an Adverse event occurs or is progressed, if applicable.<br><br>Adverse events only occur on burden of success checks.        |
| 3 | If the check passed, subtract 1d6 from the score.<br><br>If the check failed, add 1d6 to the score.                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 4 | If the check failed, add 1d6 to the Check score.<br><br>If the check passed, the Severity of the action, should it have one, increases by 1 (minimum of 1), OR, if in combat you gain 1 Opportunity Point or can take a subsequent Opportunity if not in combat.                                                   |
| 5 | If the check failed, add 1d6 to the Check score.<br><br>If the check passed, the Severity score of the action, should it have one, increases by 2 (maximum of 3) OR if in combat you gain 2 Opportunity Point or can take a subsequent Opportunity if not in combat.                                               |
| 6 | The outcome succeeds automatically, and in spectacular fashion.<br><br>You may if in combat you gain 2 Opportunity Points or can take a subsequent Opportunity if not in combat, OR gain a Recuperation point, OR gain a Fate point. The Severity of the action, should it have one, increases by 2 (maximum of 3) |

An example of a volatile situation may include sneaking around an enemy encampment where many individuals are going about unspecified activities, exploring an alien and largely unknown environment, or engaging in combat. **Combat is always volatile.**

## Check Variations & Options

### *Contests*

In some cases, two characters may be directly pitted against one another. In such cases, instead of determining the likelihood as per the normal check rules, it can be expeditious to simply have both characters roll separately, and compare scores. The highest score rolled is the successful one.

**Contests are recommended in instances where two entities with the rules associated with Player Characters are both actively trying to compete for the same outcome. They are also useful when player characters are acting against one another.**

## *Assistance and Hindering*

Assistance can be offered by characters to other characters in order to grant +1 advantage to a check. In order to assist another character, they must be physically able to provide assistance in the form of **mitigating an obstacle**, or directly and actively contribute to the same **action** performed by the character they are assisting.

Otherwise, they will need to supply some form of **leverage** (see Leverage) to be able to grant assistance.

Hindering is done in much the same way as assistance, but done in order to impose -1 disadvantage to a check. In this instance, the character must be able to **present an obstacle** or act in a way that actively **presents a difficulty** to the action performed by the character they are hindering.

To assist or hinder necessitates the use of an **action**, as per the Actions, Order of Operations & Opportunities rules.

## **4. Adverse Event**

Adverse events are unexpected events that present additional obstacles to the players. They can occur as a result of Burden of Success checks.

Standard adverse events are determined by querying one of the following questions when a adverse event occurs as a result of a **Burden of Success** check. The query is posed to the player in control of the character who triggered the adverse event.

If the first component is answered with yes, the adverse event that occurs is based on the second component of the question. If the answer is no, then the character's stress increases by 1.

A character may also choose to forego the adverse event; this also increases the character's stress by 1. If it is not realistically feasible for a adverse event to occur, the character's **stress** increases by 1.

Each adverse event has a **first effect** and a **second**, detailed below and numbered 1 and 2.

The first effect happens the first time the adverse event happens to that character within a scene. The second occurs the second time. In the event that the adverse event happens a third time, the first effect occurs again, and so on.

The GM determines how the adverse event happens in the fiction.

### *Combat Adverse events*

***Are you relying on your weapons and tools? Which are you relying on most?***

1. The tool, weapon, armour, or other becomes damaged ceases to work until **fixed**.
2. The tool, weapon, armour, or other breaks and is irreparable.

***Do you have someone you need to protect? Who is this person?***

1. Attacks against the character chosen in the second component (it may be the player themselves) are done at +1 advantage.
2. The next attack made against the chosen character automatically succeeds.

***Are you afraid of getting hurt?***

1. The character takes an injury point.
2. The character gains 1d6 injury points.

***Are you afraid of getting outnumbered?***

1. A small number (1-3) of reinforcing enemies arrive at the start of the next round.
2. A large number of reinforcing enemies (3-6) arrive at the start of the next round.

***Is there someone you are relying on? Who is this person?***

1. The character does not gain opportunity points at the start of their next turn.
2. The character does not gain opportunity points at the start of their next turn, and loses 1d6 opportunity points.

***Exploration Adverse events***

***Are you afraid of something? What here are you afraid of?***

1. The character has -1 disadvantage on checks whilst the thing they choose in the second component is in the character's immediate vicinity.
2. The character has -1 disadvantage on checks for the remainder of the scene.

***Are you in a hurry? What are you in a hurry for?***

1. The group will be late to the event that they are in a hurry for and arrive mid-way through.
2. The group will miss it entirely.

***Is there a tool or item you know you need? What is it?***

1. The item breaks and becomes unusable until it is fixed.
2. The item is irreparable.

***Are you lost?***

1. The group become disoriented and must find a way to reorient themselves.
2. The GM determines where the group end up.

***Do you feel safe? What might change that?***

1. The group are exposed to a hazard related to the answer momentarily.
2. The group are exposed to the hazard for the rest of the scene.

***Social Adverse events***

***Is there something you shouldn't say? What is it?***

1. You blurt out or inadvertently say something secret /embarrassing to a single individual.
2. Everyone heard.

***Is there someone you don't want to meet here? Who is it?***

1. They arrive in the scene, and are unaware you are there.
2. They know.

***Do you have hidden feelings for someone? Who, and what feelings?***

1. You now must confront these feelings.
2. They know.

***Is there a group or person you need to have on your side? Who or what is it?***

1. You did something in the past to truly anger them. What was it?
2. They remember.

## **5. Stress & Breakdowns**

### **Stress**

**Stress** can occur as a result of Adverse events occurring (see **Error! Reference source not found.**).

Stress starts at 0 for every character and can go up to 5. Once it reaches 5, if stress goes up any further, the character suffers a **breakdown** and becomes inactive for the remainder of the scene. The stress level then resets to 0.

Stress also resets if the player character takes a **Full Reset**.

For each level of stress a character has, they have a -1 modifier to every check made.

### **Breakdowns**

Once a character suffers a **breakdown**, a character enters a state where they have limited ability to perform actions. A breakdown lasts for the remainder of a scene.

This can take the form of being knocked unconscious, becoming exhausted, or suffering a nervous break in the face of danger. In essence, the strain of the scenario drastically reduces their ability to function in a way that is not appropriately communicated using conventional mechanics.

A character that suffers a breakdown has the following restrictions:

- All actions the character takes are done at -1 disadvantage by default.
- In a combat scenario, the maximum Opportunity Points a character can gain on their turn is limited to 1.
- Outside combat, they are considered to be in a Restricted opportunity state (as per Opportunities & Restriction)

At the start of the next scene they regain their senses.

### ***Overwhelmed***

**Response to:** chaos, complex tasks, overstimulation, responsibility

When too much happens all at once, there comes a point when even the toughest minds splinter and crack. As chaos erupts around you, you become unable to steer yourself in the storm, and it instead washes over you like a flood, pulling you under.

**How do you want to lash out, if you allowed yourself to?**

**At what point was it all too much?**

**Who do you resent for not helping?**

*Broken*

**Response to:** physical damage, exhaustion, environmental effects, poison

Some injuries aren't visible. Some hurts can seem small, but add up enough small cuts and even a titan might crumble under their weight. On the surface, you seem physically fine, but under the hood you're barely keeping it together.

**What was the thing that broke you?**

**What part of you *doesn't* hurt?**

**Who do you wish would support you?**

*Doomed*

**Response to:** Magical damage, difficult tasks, despair, crushing failure

One failure too many has instilled in you a sensation of utter hopelessness. You can feel your will to carry on waver in the face of everything that is happening around you like a curse... whether real or imagined. Little wonder your efforts flounder...

**What would be the worst thing to happen to you?**

**Who will miss you once the worst happens?**

**If only you were stronger, what would you do?**

*Overshadowed*

**Response to:** Failure, humiliation, perceived inferiority, inadequacy

Perhaps you are sufficient for your tasks on most days, but not today. You feel the attention and spotlight shine on another, and in a moment of weakness it gets the better of you. How can you possibly compare to one who defeats you in every way?

**What are others better than you at? Why does that matter to you in this moment?**

**Who do you resent for being better than you in this moment?**

**What do you wish people praised you for, just once?**

*Dazed*

**Response to:** Physical damage, magical damage, overstimulation, poison

Everything is moving too fast for you; your senses can barely keep up. You blink and struggle, but nothing seems fixed. In a haze, your mind can't help but wander to things that right now will not help you, but you are too adrift to take back control of yourself.

**What has become suddenly harder to focus on?**

**Something is distracting you... what is it?**

**You see someone else in your companion's face. Who is it?**

## *Exhausted*

**Response to:** Fatigue, stress, injury, overexertion

You are too tired to go on. You try to move, but your body and mind simply don't respond with the same efficacy they used to. Locked into a flailing body, you can only struggle to stay upright until your energy finally returns to you.

**Where would you rest, if you could?**

**Who do you resent for not doing their fair share?**

**You are insufficient for a task. What is it, and why does that bother you?**



## 6. Negotiating Outcomes & Levers

### *Basics*

In order to affect or even bypass entirely the effects of a check, an option the players have is to negotiate with the GM for either alterations to likelihood, or to significantly alter or manufacture outcomes.

In order to negotiate, the player must supply a **leverage**; that is to say, a key thing (either a physical feature or item, or a more abstract concept such as a personality trait or relationship) that is relevant to the situation and desired outcome. If a character is unable to supply a relevant leverage, the negotiation fails.

There are two types of negotiation; **major** and **minor**. Minor negotiations can be done any number of times by the player at the cost of **Recuperation**. **A major negotiation can only occur once per scene per character**, and requires the player to supply a **Penalty Counter** or a **Fate Point**.

In all cases, the outcome that occurs as a result of this negotiation must be **feasible**, but not necessarily probable by any stretch. In addition, the consequences of whatever alteration to the outcome are suggested must be phrased in **immediate** terms. **Only 1 lever can be used at a time for any negotiation.**

A successful negotiation must be agreed on by the GM, and the GM may supply counter-proposals. Once agreed, the outcome is altered as determined during the negotiation.

### *Leverage*

Leverage is varied. A player character will have by default at the end of character creation a number of **levers**, and may gain and lose more throughout the scenario. They may be tied to items they possess, traits they have gained as part of their background, and skills they have honed. By default as part of character creation, a character will have access to a substantial number of levers by default.

In order to use a lever as leverage, the lever must be:

- Logically relevant to the situation at hand.
- Emotionally or narratively significant to the situation and/or outcome.

*Note: When a lever might necessitate specific context, such as **training** or **bond**, the context is in reference to the specific character. For example, a character would not be able to leverage a form of training they would not logically have had within the fiction.*

### *Minor Negotiation*

A minor negotiation is done **before** a check is rolled. The selected lever is used to leverage **+1 advantage** on the check.

For example: *Moirag tries to leverage her superhuman strength to force open a door. The GM agrees that this is logically relevant, and therefore grants +1 advantage on the check.*

### *Major Negotiation*

A major negotiation can substantially alter an outcome both before or after a check, such as determining success or failure without making a check, by removing or substantially altering the consequences of

an outcome, etc. In order to do this, the player must clearly state the change to the outcome, and what they intend to use as leverage. This can be attempted **before or immediately after a check**.

So long as the outcome or alterations to the outcome can be phrased in so that their effect is both **immediate** and **feasible** (but not necessarily probable), the negotiation premise is valid. In general, all major negotiations should be able to be phrased in a simple, one sentence manner, such as:

*I would like to leverage my **bond** with Patricia to save her from the falling rubble.*

*I would like to leverage my **superhuman strength** to hold back the mutated ogre.*

Once this is done, the GM will ask two of the following queries, which the player must answer truthfully from the perspective of their character within the fiction. The GM chooses which two of the following questions to ask:

1. *Is your heart really still in this? What are you still fighting for?*
2. *Are you ready to die? What or who are you ready to fall for?*
3. *Do you have any hope left? What gives you hope?*
4. *Are you angry, or afraid? What pushed you over the edge?*
5. *Do you believe this is happening? What's grounding you?*
6. *Are you afraid of failing? What are you afraid of?*

The first component of each question must be answered with either **yes** or **no**. The second component must be answered by the player. If the player cannot answer either component of either question, the negotiation fails.

If the answer to the first component (*italicised*) of both questions is **yes**, the negotiation proceeds. If the answer is one **yes** and one **no**, the negotiation proceeds, but either an **adverse event** occurs or an additional **penalty counter** is applied to the character. If both answers are **no**, the negotiations end there.

If the negotiations proceed, the GM will also propose a Penalty Counter. The penalty should be related to the situation at hand and acts as a consequence to the player character in exchange for their action. **The penalty counter causes a penalty to be applied, as described in later sections.** Alternatively, if the character has a **Fate Point**, they can instead offer up the Fate Point instead of taking a penalty. The lever still becomes unavailable as described above.

Once a major negotiation has been made using a given lever, that lever cannot be used for any negotiation (minor or major) until the end of the current scene and for 1d6 subsequent scenes. Using a lever in a minor negotiation does not preclude it from being used in a major negotiation.

## Penalties

Instead of applying a harm in the form of Injury Points, the GM may also choose to apply more broad **Penalties** instead. Several abilities and traits (such as Nature Prerequisites) necessitate the application of permanent or conditional Penalties to a character. Penalties are also derived from **Penalty Counters** offered during major negotiations.

When performing a check, a GM may determine that a Penalty is applicable. Penalties act as the inverse of levers; the GM leverages a penalty within the context of the check in order to apply -1 disadvantage (in the case of the player making the check) or +1 advantage (when the GM or another character rolls a check against the player with the penalty).

Only 1 penalty can be applied to a check at a given time.

Penalties should be applied with a **context** in mind. Examples include:

- **Hurt Shoulder:** Your shoulder was injured as part of making an action. This makes it difficult to **force** items and people.
- **Stressed:** Your mind and patience have reached their limit. This makes it difficult to **concentrate**.
- **Ruined Reputation:** You have been publicly embarrassed. This makes it difficult to **impress**.
- **Exhausted:** Your stamina has reached its limit. This makes it difficult to **exert** yourself for long durations.
- **Impaired Senses:** Your eyes/ears have been damaged or impaired. This makes it difficult to **perceive**.

The GM should describe the penalty, using at least one **verb**. This verb describes the actions that the character has difficulty taking. In the above examples, the verb is in **bold**. When performing an action that can be described using that verb, the penalty can apply.

Penalties are temporary and will last for either 1d6 scenes or until mitigated. If an adverse event uses a penalty as its basis, the penalty will disappear either immediately after the adverse event or at the end of the scene, whichever is more applicable.

**Permanent penalties** or penalties with no upper limit to their duration are major difficulties for a character to overcome. Typically, permanent penalties are only applied as a result of a specific mechanic, but may be applied as a result of a severity 4 outcome if applicable.

## Mitigation

Penalties can be mitigated if a player takes significant action to counteract the nature of the penalty. The action taken must relate to the nature of the penalty and its context.

The action may be supported by the use of consumable items, or by accepting an alternative trade-off. This will depend on the nature of the penalty.

The penalty is mitigated once the above requirements are met, and then once expending a use of recuperation.

## Levers

Levers are terms that each character has that can be used as leverage in a negotiation. There is no limit to how many levers a character can have, however **a character can only have up to 6 levers active at a time**. These represent the primary elements of their personality, history, and current equipment that they can use as leverage.

Levers are granted to a character as part of a character's class, their archetype, their motivation, and from having certain items in their inventory.

A character can change their active levers as part of a **Full Reset**.

### ***Custom Leverage***

In some cases a character may have access to a lever that makes sense within the fiction, but that is not strictly covered by the list of levers available to them by the rules. In this instance, the leverage can be accepted by the GM on the following basis:

- The agreement of **all players** involved in the game
- That the use of such a lever has notable **narrative significance** to the **character** or **narrative within the fiction**
- That the use of the lever is **sick as hell**

## 7. Character Creation & Player Mechanics

There are numerous components that go into creating a character; each character is comprised of aspects that represent their background, personal motivation, their general playstyle, and their combat archetype.

Each of these components can be addressed individually if making a custom character. They are found in the following chapters, and referred to in this section.

### *Custom Characters*

Characters can be created from scratch using the tools in this document. In such a case, a character shall comprise the following features:

- |                                      |                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Level</b>                      | A description of how relatively powerful a character is. Ranges from 1 – 5. See page 30.                                                       |
| <b>2. Statistics</b>                 | Provides a description on the overall character strengths and weaknesses; covers Strength, Finesse, Intuition, and Intellect. See page 31.     |
| <b>3. Skills</b>                     | Describes how skilled a character is at specific tasks. See page 32.                                                                           |
| <b>4. Motivation</b>                 | Provides the character's general motivations and what guides their actions. See page 34.                                                       |
| <b>5. Nature &amp; Nature Traits</b> | Describes the nature of the character and provides traits they can call upon as well as limitations their nature imposes on them. See page 36. |
| <b>6. Background Talents</b>         | Additional levers that are context dependant, drawn from a character's experiences and background. 41.                                         |
| <b>7. Resources</b>                  | Covers miscellaneous resources the character gains and can use throughout the game. See page 44.                                               |
| <b>8. Combat Class</b>               | The class the character has that determines their general playstyle, particularly in combat. See page 45.                                      |
| <b>9. Abilities / Archetype</b>      | Abilities the character can draw on in combat situation. See page 51.                                                                          |

For characters who are intended to exist within a game with narrative elements, it is encouraged for the GM to discuss and prepare information and hooks with which the character may interact with the fiction.

A character that contains all above elements will have access to all mechanics necessary to represent their personality, background, their physical body and nature, their drive, and abilities related to their playstyle in combat encounters.

An explanation regarding each section is given in Characters & Character Creation. An example character sheet for custom character is provided on page 107.

## Characters & Character Creation

### Character Levels

Each character has a level. Levels describe the relative power a character has. In mechanical terms, characters with higher levels have access to more abilities, talents, nature traits, and skills.

Characters start by default at level 1 and progress in level at the GM's discretion. Short scenarios may only feature a single level throughout the length of the scenario, whereas longer scenarios may see characters progress in level at specific, impactful intervals. This represents a dramatic shift in character power.

Character levels and what resources are available to them is described in the following table.

| Level | Abilities | Talents | Statistics | Skills |
|-------|-----------|---------|------------|--------|
| 1     | 1         | 2       |            | 5      |
| 2     | 2         |         | +1         | +1     |
| 3     | 2         | 3       |            | +1     |
| 4     | 3         |         | +1         | +1     |
| 5     | 3         | 4       |            | +1     |

In addition to character levels, a character will also progress in class levels. Class levels grant additional abilities and levers specific to that class. Classes are covered in later sections.

*Note: A character does not require a class in order to be played. In games that do not heavily feature combat, classes may not be required!*

As a rule of thumb, a character of levels 1 will be newer, inexperienced characters that only have their background experience to draw on. Levels 2 – 3 represent experienced characters who have a broader range of experience to draw from and who are better equipped to face more challenging scenarios. Levels 4 – 5 represent elite, veteran characters who are prepared to face legendary challenges.

# Statistics

## *Statistics Overview*

Statistics cover the general descriptive traits of a character. They are covered by:

1. **Strength:** Covers muscle, power, and conditioning. Lift heavy weights. Swing big weapons. Enjoy a healthy constitution.
2. **Finesse:** Covers fine motor skills, speed, and quick reflexes. Perform agile feats and delicate motions. Dodge bullets.
3. **Intuition:** Covers practical knowledge and interpersonal understanding. Understand practical things without book-learning. Communicate with others clearly and intuitively.
4. **Intellect:** Covers mind-intensive capacity. Memorise facts and perform intensive mental calculations. Interpret complex systems.

## *Statistics Modifiers*

Each statistic has an associated modifier depending on the statistic score. These can be added to certain checks when the statistic is relevant to the check situation, or if a skill relevant to the check situation that derives from the check is used.

The modifiers for each statistic score is listed in the table below.

| Score | Modifier | Score | Modifier |
|-------|----------|-------|----------|
| 1     | -3       | 7     | 0        |
| 2     | -3       | 8     | +1       |
| 3     | -3       | 9     | +2       |
| 4     | -2       | 10    | +3       |
| 5     | -1       | 11    | +3       |
| 6     | 0        | 12    | +3       |

## *Statistics above 10*

A statistic score of 10 represents the typical peak of human ability. However, since some characters are exceptional, their scores may go beyond the typical limits of what is considered 'normal'.

When a character has a statistic of 11 or higher, they gain a **Superhuman** lever tied to that statistic:

**Superhuman Strength; Superhuman Finesse; Superhuman Intuition; Superhuman Intellect**

The character lists their superhuman lever on their character sheet and can use it as part of Negotiation.

## *Determining Statistics*

Statistics are generated on character creation. There are 2 ways to determine character statistics: by **rolling**, or by selecting a **pre-determined** set.

If rolling, roll 3d6 and drop the lowest score. The sum of the remaining dice is stored. This is repeated 3 more times. Each score is then allocated to a Statistic of the player's choosing.

Warning: *This can yield a character with a statistic of 2!*

Alternatively, a pre-determined set can be selected from the following options:

| Distribution type: | Balanced   | Specialised |
|--------------------|------------|-------------|
| Statistic Scores:  | 8; 7; 5; 4 | 11; 5; 5; 3 |

Note: *Pre-determined statistics, on average, have a lower total than the average expected by rolling; however, rolling introduces the risk of having characters with ludicrously unbalanced statistics.*

## Skills

### *Skill Overview*

Skills are learned proficiencies that allow characters to interact with the world around them. There are a lot of skills to choose from, and similarly to statistic modifiers, when performing an action that necessitates a check involving one of these skills, you can add your skill modifier to the check.

Your skill modifier is equal to your level in that skill. You can gain up to 3 levels in a skill. There are 4 groups that skills correspond to, which correspond to the character statistics as described above.

| Strength               | Finesse                    | Intuition                | Intellect                          |
|------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Close Quarters Combat  | Ranged Combat              | Riding & Animal Control  | Arcanothurgy                       |
| Defence                | Vehicle Control            | Acting & Performance     | Religion                           |
| Unarmed / Martial Arts | Survival & Nature Crafting | Deception & Misdirection | History, Politics & Geography      |
| Fitness & Conditioning | Tinkering & Repair         | Eloquence & Oration      | Medicine & Biology                 |
| Heavy Weapon Operation | Acrobatics & Body Control  | Art & Music              | Law & Philosophy                   |
| Manual Labour          | Combat Finesse             | People Reading           | Engineering, Mathematics & Physics |

### *Skill List*

|                                   |                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Close Quarters Combat</b>      | Hit enemies in combat with close quarters combat weapons.             |
| <b>Defence</b>                    | Withstand and protect yourself and others from harm.                  |
| <b>Unarmed / Martial Arts</b>     | Display martial arts skills. Fight with the weapons nature gave you.  |
| <b>Fitness &amp; Conditioning</b> | Be strong. Have stamina. Lift heavy weights. Run far without fatigue. |



|                                               |               |                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Heavy Operation</b>                        | <b>Weapon</b> | Wield and interface with heavy weapons. Includes weapons mounted on vehicles, or weapons intended to be mounted on vehicles. |
| <b>Manual Labour</b>                          |               | Work with your hands and muscles.                                                                                            |
| <b>Ranged Combat</b>                          |               | Hit and hurt enemies at a distance with rifles and bows.                                                                     |
| <b>Vehicle Control</b>                        |               | Control vehicles. Make tight corners. Reach high speeds.                                                                     |
| <b>Survival &amp; Crafting</b>                | <b>Nature</b> | Use your hands to craft items in the wild. Be able to start campfires and prepare survival equipment in the wild.            |
| <b>Tinkering &amp; Repair</b>                 |               | Dextrously put together fiddly components and repair difficult devices.                                                      |
| <b>Acrobatics &amp; Control</b>               | <b>Body</b>   | Perform complex jumps and display impressive coordination. Move without excessive noise.                                     |
| <b>Combat Finesse</b>                         |               | Perform tricks in combat. Disarm opponents. Use weapons with agility rather than strength.                                   |
| <b>Ranged Combat</b>                          |               | Hit and hurt enemies at a distance with rifles and bows.                                                                     |
| <b>Riding &amp; Animal Control</b>            |               | Interact with animals positively and convince them to let you ride them.                                                     |
| <b>Acting &amp; Performance</b>               |               | Adopt personas that are not your own. Wield attention and wow crowds.                                                        |
| <b>Deception &amp; Misdirection</b>           | <b>&amp;</b>  | Convince others that what is false is not. Lie by omission without getting caught.                                           |
| <b>Eloquence &amp; Oration</b>                |               | Present information in a clear and convincing manner. Reap the benefits of coherent public speaking.                         |
| <b>Art &amp; Music</b>                        |               | Understand artistic intent and convey it. Perform music with instruments. Handle paints.                                     |
| <b>People Reading</b>                         |               | Read people without using words. Intuit body language. Have hunches about people.                                            |
| <b>Arcanothurgy</b>                           |               | Understand magic. Cast spells. Unravel reality.                                                                              |
| <b>Religion</b>                               |               | Understand religions and cult behaviour. Commune with gods.                                                                  |
| <b>History, Politics &amp; Geography</b>      | <b>&amp;</b>  | Understand local politics and how they happened. Know the differences between countries. Appreciate history.                 |
| <b>Medicine &amp; Biology</b>                 |               | Understand and heal people. Learn and understand alien biology. Concoct drugs.                                               |
| <b>Law &amp; Philosophy</b>                   |               | Understand and manipulate the law. Interpret the philosophies of societies and debate them successfully.                     |
| <b>Engineering, Mathematics &amp; Physics</b> |               | Know the natural laws and use them to your advantage. Perform difficult calculations. Engineer successful devices.           |

## *Skill Levers*

When you have a level 3 in a skill, you gain that skill as a **skill lever** as **expertise**. For example:

**Manual Labour Expertise; Medicine & Biology Expertise; Deception & Misdirection Expertise**

A character lists all their skill levers on their character sheet and can use them as levers as part of a negotiation.

## *Skill modifiers and Statistic Modifiers*

Modifiers for skills stack with the modifiers for statistics. In general, if a skill is relevant to a check, then the statistic is also relevant for the check. As described in the Checks section, the total modifiers used for a check cannot exceed +/-5.

## **Motivations**

### *Motivation Overview*

Characters are complex, and typically cannot be easily categorised as purely good or evil. Instead of general ideas of good and evil, specific **motivation** is important for player characters, because few scenarios involve characters engaging in safe, comfortable situations. They will need that motivation to keep moving forwards, despite the peril.

On character creation, a character selects **2 Motivations**. A motivation is something that grants them personal fulfilment and strength.

Once per Scene (typically at the end of a scene, but not necessarily), if the GM determines that your character has fulfilled a motivation, the player flips a coin. On heads, the character gains a **Fate Point**. This can only happen once per scene per character.

**A character can have a maximum of 3 Fate Points at any given time.**

When determining whether a character fulfils a motivation, the GM must determine whether the motivation was fulfilled meaningfully. Typically, this requires a degree of action to be taken by the character, or some notable trade-off to have been made in order to fulfil the motivation.

A motivation that occurs by itself without the character's input is not likely meaningful to the character, and therefore will not in most cases fulfil the motivation.

When you pick a motivation, you may select **one** of the two levers associated with the motivation.

### *Example Motivations*

- |                     |                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Destroyer</b> | You gain strength from causing harm and destroying your enemies in combat.<br>( <b>Rage, Malice</b> )                  |
| <b>2. Learner</b>   | You are invigorated by gaining knowledge and discovering more about unknown things. ( <b>Curiosity, Adaptability</b> ) |

3. **Explorer**      You gain experience by visiting new places and seeing new things in person.  
(**Stamina, Survival Experience**)
4. **Fearless**      You gain experience by taking on challenges that are dangerous and facing foes far stronger than you, willingly. (**Courage, Grit**)
5. **Friend & Lover**      You gain strength from forming intimate and strong relationships with others. (**Personality, Bond**)
6. **Supporter**      You derive strength from supporting those you consider meaningfully close to you when it's hard. (**Bond, Teamwork**)
7. **Inventor**      You love tinkering and creating new things, and making them work. (**Creativity, Use of Tools**)
8. **Rebel**      You are invigorated by taking a stand against a system, corrupt or otherwise. (**Rage, Idealism**)
9. **Manipulator**      You gain experience by manipulating others into taking courses of action in accordance with your design. (**Speechcraft, Reason**)
10. **Honest**      You derive strength from speaking the truth when a lie would be more convenient. (**Reputation, Idealism**)
11. **Saviour**      You derive strength from saving others from danger and harm. (**Heroism, Inspirational Presence**)
12. **Hoarder**      You gain experience from increasing your wealth substantially. (**Financial Skills, Influence**)
13. **Daredevil**      You are invigorated by danger; coming close to death gets you going. (**Grit, Energy**)
14. **Enforcer**      You gain experience from enforcing law and order, whether just or otherwise. (**Reputation, Reason**)
15. **Diplomat**      You gain strength from solving problems non-violently. (**Idealism, Speechcraft**)
16. **Monster Hunter**      You gain strength from facing down evil monsters and abominations in combat. (**Heroism, Hunting Experience**)
17. **Validation Seeker**      You are invigorated when you prove your worth to someone who doesn't believe in you. (**Ambition, Rage**)
18. **Leader**      You gain strength from successfully taking charge of situations and leading others through difficult scenarios. (**Influence, Personality**)

## *Designing Custom Motivations*

Players and GMs may work together to either alter or invent a new motivation specific to the character.

When designing your own Motivation, consider that a motivation should have two core characteristics; the motivation should *encourage action*, that is to say it should guide the character towards interacting with the environment and others in a specific way, and it must be context-specific, meaning it must require a certain level of specificity related to how the action must happen. ‘Fighting’, for example, is not context-specific, and therefore is unsuitable as a motivation as it is not context-specific, and neither is ‘being around arcane knowledge’, as it does not encourage interaction in any way.

## **Character Nature**

### *Nature Overview*

Each character has a Nature; this is a mixture of their species and key physiological features that give them advantages and disadvantages. Each type of Nature grants access to a specific Nature Trait; the character at creation selects two from any type, but must obey the requirements of each.

Select 2 traits from any the following categories, and work with the GM to adhere to the requirements of each type.

### *Humanoid*

Humanoids are the most numerous types of intelligent creature in most settings. They may be humans, orc-kind, dwarves, or a type of alien lifeform, but they are defined primarily by how common they are to find in whatever setting they happen to find themselves in.

Humanoids have skill-based traits that stem from living amongst sociable creatures. Since individuals who choose to follow the path of adventure, hardship, and war are among the bravest of their kind, humanoids can also surprise many more powerful entities with their pluck and gumption in the face of danger.

**Skilled:** Choose an Intuition or Intellect based skill and gain a skill level. Gain the **Training** lever.

**Relatable:** Gain the **Relatability** lever.

**Quick Learner:** When you make a check using a skill you have no levels in, you can gain +1 advantage on the check once, and regain use of this ability when you Recuperate.

**Underdog:** Whilst you have at least a level 1 injury, you can gain advantage on one check of your choice, and regain use of this ability when you Recuperate.

**City Mouse:** Gain the **Urban Knowledge** lever.

**Country Mouse:** Gain the **Rural Understanding** lever.

## Monstrous

Monstrous natures are defined by having bestial, feral, or animalistic abilities. They may be near-humanoid in appearance, such as a jaguar-kind individual, a werewolf, or a selkie. They are noticeably monstrous and have exaggerated physical abilities at the detriment of some of their other abilities.

Prerequisite: Identify a monstrous or unnatural physical characteristic. This may unnerve civilians unused to monstrous power. You gain a permanent penalty: **Monstrous Appearance**. This penalty can also be used as a lever.

In addition, add +2 to a Statistic of your choice, and subtract 2 from another.

- Monstrous Attack:** When you take the Attack opportunity, you can make another attack for free with a monstrous appendage such as fangs, claws, a spiked tail, or other; this monstrous attack has **no severity limit**. The attack uses your **Unarmed / Martial Arts** skill modifier. You gain the **monstrous natural weapon** lever.
- Thick Hide:** Whilst you are not wearing armour, when you gain one or more injury points from a single source, you can choose to take one less injury point. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your character level, and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Adaptation:** You can gain one of the following adaptations:
- You can swim; in combat your swimming speed is equal to your movement speed. Out of combat swimming cannot contribute to check complexity. You also gain the ability to breathe underwater. You gain the **aquatic adaptation** lever.
- You can climb; in combat your climbing speed is equal to your movement speed and you can jump up to your movement speed. Out of combat, climbing cannot contribute to check complexity. You gain the **climbing adaptation** lever.
- You can fly; in combat you can fly up to your movement speed, however you must land by the end of your next turn. Outside of combat you can fly for short durations, however it is very taxing to perform continuously. You gain the **winged adaptation** lever.
- Feral Speed:** You are incredibly fast. In combat, when you take the Move opportunity, you can immediately take the Move opportunity again once. You regain the use of this ability when you Recuperate. You gain the **monstrous speed** lever.
- Hulking Size:** You are titanic. Your character can be as large as 4 metres in any dimension, and you count as Large. You gain the **monstrous size** lever.
- Scavenger:** You do not need rations or prepared food to survive; you can survive eating rotted meat, spoiled food, and garbage without incurring any penalty. You gain the **scavenger nature** lever.

## Undead

Either fully undead or not-quite alive, undead are creatures whose souls and life have been irrevocably altered. Whilst they still maintain a physical form, it is typically harder to put them down permanently and they may demonstrate otherworldly resilience. However, their ties to this world are feebler than most and experience lethargy or delayed reactions.

Determine with your GM a manner in which your undead nature renders interacting with the living world difficult; typically, this may be weakened ability to sense their surroundings, difficulties coordinating, or difficulties emoting and feeling empathy. You gain a permanent **penalty** based on the results of this discussion.

Examples include: **lethargic; fragile body; unempathetic; clumsy**

1. **Phantom:** You are only somewhat corporeal. You can phase through objects, walls, and inorganic substances. This cannot be done through items or creatures with souls (as their soul will reject yours). Items you are wearing and carrying also phase with you, unless they carry a soul. You gain the **incorporeal form** lever.  
  
Remaining incorporeal for more than brief periods of time puts you at risk of permanently dematerialising.
2. **Revive:** When you die, if you are willing and it is possible to do so, you return to life within 1d6 scenes.
3. **Commune:** You are not fully alive, and therefore you can communicate to a limited degree with the spirits of the dead in the form of fragmented phrases, sensations, emotional resonance, and snippets of images.  
  
You can do this a number of times equal to your character level, and regain a use when you Recuperate.
4. **Unkillable:** You can only die if your body is completely obliterated. Examples include being exploded into chunks, being evaporated into a mist, being devoured by monsters, or having your existence wiped from the timeline. If you suffer an injury that would be fatal that does not meet these requirements, you do not die, but may be incapacitated.
5. **Vampiric:** You can survive on a diet of fresh blood.  
  
In combat, when you successfully deal an injury point to a target, you can lose 1 injury point. You can do this once, and regain a use when you Recuperate.
6. **Possessed:** You do not have a body, but instead exist as a soul within an item, such as a phylactery, that is possessing a body. The body you are possessing can be destroyed as normal, however when this happens, the item your soul exists in can be transferred to another host.  
  
To successfully do this the new host must either be willing, or be recently deceased with an intact body. The possession returns the body to life.

## *Artificial*

Artificial nature means that the creature is either wholly or partially artificial. They may be an arcanotech construct or a clone. Their artificial nature grants them greater control over their form and they may feature quality of life upgrades, however they typically have more strict requirements requiring how they maintain themselves.

Determine with your GM an additional requirement that your artificial character needs in order to function; this may be additional food to power a cloned body, biomatter to perform repairs on your flesh, or arcanotech batteries in order to power your limbs. If you are unable to maintain this requirement, the GM can apply the **low on energy** penalty until it is satisfied.

1. **Integrated Weapon:** You gain a weapon integrated into your body. It may be either stored in a mechanical compartment or be grown out of your flesh. The weapon must be one-handed.

This weapon cannot be removed from your person unless you lose a limb. In addition, it does not cost an Opportunity to equip or unequip this weapon. If the weapon has the ammunition property, if it requires reloading, it reloads automatically without requiring ammunition at the end of the scene, and can otherwise be reloaded as normal.

You gain the **integrated weapon** lever.
2. **Integrated Armour:** Whilst not wearing armour, you can either be considered to wear light or heavy armour (choose which when you select this trait). This cannot be removed from your person.
3. **Clone:** You are not unique. When you die, you can return (if willing and it is physically possible to do so) as a new body within 1d6 scenes.

Your memories are retained up until the moment you died, and are re-installed inside a new body.
4. **Artificial Regeneration:** You can heal from injuries using mechanical components instead of medical equipment. For the purposes of healing from injuries, 2 mechanical components counts as Advanced medical kit, and 1 counts as First Aid supplies.
5. **Enhanced Ability:** You gain +2 to either Strength or Finesse.
6. **Tireless:** Your maximum Recuperation points increase by +2.

## *Mystical*

You have a mystical or otherworldly component to your nature; you may originate from a separate plane, or commune with spirits, or be one yourself. Mystical abilities grant unusual advantages, but characters with this nature have a ritual they must perform as part of their strange nature.

Choose a curse from Curses. This is the cost of your mystical benefits.

1. **Foresight:** Once, you may ask the GM to make a prediction, which the GM must provide in the form of either a vague hint, a fragment of an image, or a specific prediction of an event that will occur.  
  
The event can occur within 1d6 scenes. If this event occurs, you gain +1 advantage on any checks that involve the prediction. If it does not, flip a coin; on heads, you gain a Fate Point.  
  
You regain a use of this ability when the prediction is proven either true, or false.
2. **Immortality** You do not age, either at all or noticeably, and so long as you are not killed you are functionally immortal. You gain the **immortality** lever.
3. **Mindreader** You are able to telepathically read minds to a limited extent. At all times you can sense the surface-level emotions of thinking creatures, which may be communicated by the GM as single-word descriptions. A creature can only guard against this ability by knowingly choosing to control their surface-level thoughts.  
  
You gain the **telepathy** lever.
4. **Forebear's Knowledge** You can tap into a communal memory, an ancestor's guidance, or other source of knowledge that you have mystical access to.  
  
Once per scene, you can choose any skill. You gain a level in this skill for the duration of the scene, and lose it at the end of the scene.
5. **Mystical Assault** You can emit arcane or divine energy during your attacks. Choose either Fire, Electricity, Cold, Divine, or Unholy energy. A number of times equal to your character level, you can change the damage type from any physical attack to that energy type.
6. **Glamour** You take the appearance of an ethereally beautiful, hypnotic, or otherwise enchanting creature. Those who see you automatically view you as more beautiful and charming. You gain the **Glamour** lever.  
  
In Combat, you can as an Opportunity target a creature you can sense and that can sense you. On a successful check, the target becomes beguiled and loses 1d6 Opportunity Points. Abominations are immune to this ability; you are nothing that can interest them. You can use this ability in combat a number of times equal to your character level, and regain a use when you Recuperate.



## Background Talents

Background **talents** are context-dependent abilities that are linked to the personality and background of the character. They grant substantial bonuses when making checks based on skills. The player can choose from the list below or work with the GM to develop their own.

A background talent represents a specific area in which your character is accustomed to navigating. Talents are distinct from levers, as they can only be called on in a specific context, and can stack alongside **minor negotiations**.

This means that a character can benefit from +1 advantage from a minor negotiation, as well as a +1 advantage from a talent so long as they are within the context of the talent.

You can benefit from your talents a number of times equal to the maximum number of talents you have available, as listed in the Character Levels section.

- 1. Diversity** Your character is accustomed to navigating people of diverse cultures; when **making a BS check in a social encounter**, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 2. Brawler** Your character knows to hit first and hit hard; when starting a fight or making the first move in an aggressive action during a social encounter, your character can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 3. Seducer** Your character is accustomed to appealing to people in a romantic or sensual manner; when making a check intended to flirt or seduce another character, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 4. Down with the Establishment!** Your character knows how to stir up trouble for the ruling powers. When making an Eloquence & Oration, Art & Music, or Acting & Performance check intended to rile an individual or group up against a powerful organisation, establishment, or institution, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 5. Army Talk** Your character understands how to communicate effectively with people who live a military lifestyle. When making a check in a social encounter with a soldier, officer, or other member of the armed forces, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 6. Experienced Traveller** When making a check with either Geography & Politics or Survival & Nature Crafting to situate yourself or travel effectively through a region, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 7. Gourmand** You are accustomed to eating well, no matter the circumstances. When making a check with Survival & Nature Crafting to cook ingredients with the intention of making an edible meal you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 8. Rough Reputation** You have a reputation that inspires fear and caution in others. When making a check intended to intimidate or scare others in a social encounter that leverages the reputation of the character, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.

- 9. False Reputation** You have a reputation to maintain, even if it isn't real. When making a check intended to deceive others as to a false or manufactured reputation or persona, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 10. Good with Animals** You are better with animals than you are with people. When making a check intended to interact in a non-hostile manner with animals, beasts, and wildlife, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 11. Battlefield-Savvy** You have a wealth of knowledge about battlefield and wartime matters. You can request the GM to provide an insight on a matter related to war or military proceedings in the form of rumours, hearsay, intuition, or inference.
- 12. Shadow Stealth** You are accustomed to blending into the shadows. When attempting to escape attention by concealing yourself in darkness, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 13. Jury-Rig Mechanic** You have fixed dozens of things without strictly speaking the right parts. When attempting to fix a mechanical item without the appropriate materials, you can add +1 Advantage to the check if you can find an approximate replacement.
- 14. Professional Carouser** You are not easily put under the table, no matter the circumstances. In social encounters, your character can add +1 advantage to checks related to imbibing alcohol, narcotics, or showing up others in a carousing or party context.
- 15. Rebel Style** You can make simple attire look good. When making a check to impress or fit into a social group whilst wearing simple clothing, you can add +1 advantage to the check.
- 16. Unique Senses** You are highly sensitive, and can perceive things others cannot see. When making a check to sense or perceive something that cannot be seen, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 17. Firestarter** You like the pretty fires. When making a check to start, harness, or expand a fire, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 18. Sea Legs** You were born on board a ship, or act like it. When making a check involving water-based vehicles or that involves seamanship, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 19. Streetrunner** You know alleyways and crowds and how to navigate them. When making a check involving traversing urban environments quickly, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 20. From the Trenches** You are accustomed to the horrors of war and are used to finding ways to survive in the harshest of man-made environments. When making a check in order to navigate or perform survival activities in a trench or battlefield environment, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.
- 21. High-Class Socialite** You know how to talk to the rich, the powerful, the famous. When making a check to interact with individuals from high social backgrounds, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.

- |                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>22. Unarmed Intimidation</b>  | You are uniquely intimidating when carrying no weapons. When making a check intended to intimidate, scare, or frighten a character or group whilst no weapon is equipped or in your inventory, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.                                                                               |
| <b>23. Subterranean Expert</b>   | You are used to life underground. When making a check in order to navigate or perform survival activities in a cave, mine, or other underground environment, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.                                                                                                                 |
| <b>24. Fallen Empires Expert</b> | You are a great student of ancient ruins, or are accustomed to navigating them. When making a check in order to use an Intellect skill for a check related to an empire, civilisation, or society that no longer exists (or is known to exist), you can add +1 Advantage to the check.                              |
| <b>25. Arcanotech Academic</b>   | You are a great student of arcanotech and mechanics, and know how to orient yourself in academic circles on the subject. When making a check in order to use an Intellect skill for a check related to an existent or non-existent piece of technology or arcano-technology, you can add +1 Advantage to the check. |
| <b>26. Kitchen Alchemist</b>     | You can turn everyday substances into something... workable. When making a check in order to manufacture a medicine, drug, or other concoction, and you do not have the appropriate components, you can add +1 Advantage to the check so long as you can use some commonly available substitute.                    |
| <b>27. Freaky Weirdo</b>         | You're weird, creepy, strange, and uncomfortable to deal with. When making a check as part of a social encounter to unnerve, freak out, or unsettle an individual or group, you can add +1 Advantage to the check so long as you do something suitably... unusual.                                                  |
| <b>28. Pickpocket</b>            | Your fingers are sticky, yet somehow they don't get caught very easily. When making a check to try and pickpocket a person or lift an item from a worn bag, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.                                                                                                                  |
| <b>29. Distracting Performer</b> | You are especially talented at performing in a way that distracts from something else happening behind you. When using the Art & Music or the Acting & Performance skill to create a distraction, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.                                                                            |
| <b>30. Grit</b>                  | You bite through the pain. When making a check to overcome pain or work through an injury, you can add +1 Advantage to the check.                                                                                                                                                                                   |

Talents provide advantage when making a skill check in a specific context; that is to say, the Talent will not automatically be applicable just because a skill it is tied to gets used; other context-dependent triggers must be active for the Talent to apply. Background Talents are not generally applicable in combat, and are more free-form advantages intended for use in either exploration or social scenarios.

When developing a custom Talent, consider the context that is relevant to the characters background.

## Resources

Characters also have access to several trackable resources that depend on their level and on some statistics.

### *Recuperation Points & Recuperation*

Recuperation points are a measure of the character's stamina, capacity to use mechanics associated with their abilities, and general energy. Recuperation points enable Recuperation, which restores ability use throughout the game as well as serves as a means to manage damage taken.

A character has a maximum number of Recuperation points equal to their character level + 4.

**Beyond any additional regained uses of abilities, levers, and other resources, when Recuperating a character loses 1d6 injury points.**

### *Injury Points*

Injury points represent the damage your character has taken over the course of the scenario. These will eventually result in a character gaining an Injury if they become high enough. Both the Injury Threshold and the Harm Threshold (the amount of damage required to gain an Injury Point) must be tracked.

### *Injury Threshold*

If Injury Points reach your Injury Threshold, the character will develop an Injury, as described in the Injury sections.

**Injury Threshold is equal to 3 + their Character Level.**

### *Maximum Opportunity Points*

**Exclusive to combat.** Opportunity Points enable character to perform Opportunities during combat encounters and must be managed in order to keep the character able to perform actions when needed and not run out of steam. At the start of combat Opportunity Points are set to 0, as described in the combat section, but the maximum you can have at any time is determined as below.

**Your maximum Opportunity Points is equal to 3 + your character level.**

### *Fortune Points*

Representative of a character's wealth, Fortune Points are used for transactions outside of combat. Fortune is covered in-depth in later sections.

**At character creation a character begins the scenario with 1d6 Fortune Points, unless otherwise specified as part of character creation.**

### *Character Size*

Unless otherwise specified from an ability or trait, a character's size is always considered medium. This corresponds to **any size up to 2 metres in any dimension.**

## Character Classes

Classes are archetypes for characters that dictate what their primary tools are when in combat. Different classes will fight in radically different ways and have different approaches in combat that enable them to work as a team to defeat their opponents.

Classes also grant access to special class levers that can be leveraged as normal, representing their training and abilities.

A character gains a level in a class when they increase their character level. Characters can select which class they have at character creation and gain access to all abilities available to the class as a whole for that level. In addition, all classes have sub-types that further specify their abilities and how they operate in combat.

Characters can choose any class to gain a level in when they level up; for example a character who is level 2 may have one level in Warrior and one level in Caster, but will only have the first level of abilities available from each class. However, characters can only ever have one subtype from any single class (meaning a character cannot have abilities from both the Soldier subtype and the Brawler subtype).

### *Warrior*

#### ***Warrior Overview***

The Warrior is a reliable fighter. Able to equip the most protective equipment and make the best use out of their equipment, they are reliable damage-dealers in the heat of combat. No squadron would ever want to face an enemy without at least one hardened warrior by their side to dish out some damage. Able to attack multiple times, a Warrior can outpace anyone in a straight brawl.

**Soldiers** are disciplined and maximise their reliability when using weapons in combat. They know that they are expected to fight kill and intend to make themselves the best at this role. Their Battle Advantage allows them greater odds to succeed with their weaponry, making them uniquely deadly to face.

**Brawlers** rely more on raw grit to succeed; tougher and able to dig deep when it matters, they are the sorts of fighters that will stick around longer than anyone would give them credit for. Their Toughness allows them to reduce incoming damage when they take hits, and their Energy allows them to have a continuous reserve of extra power for when they need it.

Upon gaining a level in Warrior for the first time, you may select **two** of the following Levers:

**Training – Grit – Strength – Aim – Resilience – Stamina**

If you already have a level from another class when you gain your first level in Warrior, you only select **one** lever.

### ***Warrior Abilities***

| <b>Warrior Level</b> | <b>Class Abilities</b> | <b>Soldier</b>       | <b>Brawler</b>            |
|----------------------|------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>1</b>             | Additional Attacks (1) | Battle Advantage (1) | Toughness (1), Energy (1) |
| <b>2</b>             | Additional Attacks (2) | Battle Advantage (2) | Toughness (2)             |
| <b>3</b>             | Additional Attacks (3) | Battle Advantage (3) | Energy (2)                |
| <b>4</b>             | Additional Attacks (4) | Battle Advantage (4) | Toughness (3)             |
| <b>5</b>             | Additional Attacks (5) | Battle Advantage (5) | Energy (3)                |

**Additional Attacks** When you take the Attack opportunity on your turn, you can make a number of free attacks using the same weapon equal to your level in this ability.

**Battle Advantage** When you take the Attack opportunity, you can grant yourself +1 advantage on all attacks and free attacks made as part of that opportunity. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you Recuperate.

**Toughness** Your Injury Threshold increases by an amount equal to your level in this ability.

In addition, when you take damage in combat from an attack of severity 2 or higher, you can reduce the severity of the attack by 1. You can do this a number of times equal to your level in this ability and regain a use when you recuperate.

**Energy** When you take any hostile opportunity against a target (such as Attack, Hinder, or Expose) in combat, you can make a free attack against the target if you are within range. You can do this a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you recuperate.

## Caster

### Caster Overview

A caster uses primarily magic to succeed; either warping reality using arcane spells or by calling upon divinities and outer powers to act upon the waking world. All Casters, however, have the same basic abilities to erupt with magical energies and to use their powers to ward off similarly powerful effects.

**Arcanothurges** are skilled users of reality-warping abilities; the greatest Arcanothurges are powerful archmagi and deadly wizard-kings, but even the common Arcanothurge can use powerful magic to turn the tide. Spellcrafting allows for unpredictable and highly customisable spells to shape the world around them. Arcanothurges view magic as a science and can selectively craft their spell outputs to have highly specific outcomes.

**Ideationists** conjure and manifest unusual effects by bringing into physical being concepts and ideas they have aligned themselves with. Frequently ideationists may be cultists to a divinity or divine concept and manifest their beliefs using ideationism, but they may also be powerful intuitive spellcasters in their own right that are able to use their abilities to manifest alterations in their environment. They are less controlled than arcanothurges, but no less powerful.

Upon gaining a level in Caster for the first time, you may select **two** of the following Levers:

**Wisdom – Education – Mysticism – Psionics – Divine Favour – Eldritch Power**

If you already have a level from another class when you gain your first level in Caster, you only select **one** lever.

### Caster Abilities

| Caster | Class Abilities            | Arcanothurge Abilities  | Ideationist Abilities                         |
|--------|----------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1      | Magic Attack (1), Ward (1) | Arcane Spellcasting (1) | Ideation Casting (1), Minor Manifestation (1) |
| 2      | Magic Attack (2)           | Arcane Spellcasting (2) | Ideation Casting (2)                          |
| 3      | Ward (2)                   | Arcane Spellcasting (3) | Ideation Casting (3), Minor Manifestation (2) |
| 4      | Magic Attack (3)           | Arcane Spellcasting (4) | Ideation Casting (4)                          |
| 5      | Ward (3)                   | Arcane Spellcasting (5) | Ideation Casting (5), Minor Manifestation (3) |

**Magic Attack** You can make magical attacks. This attack's damage type is either fire, cold, or energy, and the attack is made using your **Arcanothurgy** or **Religion** modifier. The attack has a **short** range.

**Arcane Ward** When you or something you can sense are subject to a Magical effect in combat, you can attempt to negate the effect. Roll a d6; if the result is below 6 – your level in this ability, the effect is completely negated as you counter the magical effect.

You gain the **Arcane Ward** lever.

**Arcane Spellcasting** Arguably the most powerful form of magic in the known world, Arcane Spellcasting allows you to upend the natural order in a manner you see fit. Using the **Arcane Spellcasting** appendix, describe the effect you wish to happen to the GM and work out the effects.

You can perform Arcane Spellcasting a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you Recuperate.

Arcane Spellcasting in combat is used as an Opportunity. Arcane Spellcasting can be used outside of combat.

**Ideation** Ideation relies on manifesting an idea or concept into reality. It is a complex and unpredictable skill that relies on having a clear understanding of concepts. Using the **Ideation Casting** appendix, determine your **desire** and attempt to manifest it.

You can perform Ideation a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you Recuperate.

In combat Ideation is used as an opportunity. Ideation can be used outside of combat.

**Minor Manifestation** As an opportunity, you manifest a reduced version of your **Imagined Form** (see **Ideation Casting** Appendix). You can use this manifestation as a weapon for a single attack, in which case it deals either fire, cold, or energy damage. Attacks made with your Imagined Form are made at +1 advantage, or if your Imagined Form is not suitable as a weapon, attacks made whilst it is manifested are made at +1 advantage. If manifested as a weapon, you decide whether it is one or two-handed once summoned.

The manifestation appears either on your person (such as in your hand or on your arm) or in your immediate vicinity (such as hovering over your shoulder).

The Minor Manifestation lasts until the end of your next turn. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you Recuperate.



## Agent

### Agent Overview

Agents are specialists at solving problems with less (if not no) violence. Highly skilled and able to navigate unconventional situations without brutally attacking things or casting complex and unreliable spells, having an agent on your side often means you'll have a skilled and versatile specialist.

**Saboteurs** are adept at undermining opponents in combat and helping in more unorthodox ways. They are the infiltrators, assassins, and thieves of this world. They can exploit targets to make them vulnerable, as well as always find a way to be where they need to be.

**Supporters** by contrast might not be made for combat at all; these are skilled, versatile individuals with a variety of skills, and aim to assist in combat by aiding the rest of their team and ensuring that they get the job done. These are the medics, technicians, and misplaced civilians of this world.

Upon gaining a level in Agent for the first time, you may select **two** of the following Levers:

**Cunning – Perception – Luck – Background – Charm – Speed**

If you already have a level from another class when you gain your first level in Agent, you only select **one** lever.

### Agent Abilities

| Agent | Class Abilities                        | Saboteur Abilities        | Supporter Abilities                            |
|-------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Reliability (1), Seize Opportunity (1) | Exploit (1), Mobility (1) | Maximise Support (1), Excellent Assistance (1) |
| 2     | Seize Opportunity (2)                  | Mobility (2)              | Maximise Support (2)                           |
| 3     | Reliability (2)                        | Exploit (2)               | Excellent Assistance (2)                       |
| 4     | Seize Opportunity (3)                  | Mobility (3)              | Maximise Support (3)                           |
| 5     | Reliability (3)                        | Exploit (3)               | Excellent Assistance (3)                       |

**Reliability** You gain a bonus modifier to all checks until the end of your next turn equal to your level in this ability. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you recuperate.

**Seize Opportunity** When in combat, at the start of your turn, you can gain a number of free Opportunity Points equal to your level in this ability. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you Recuperate.

In addition, when you gain Opportunity points as a result of Volatility, you gain an additional number of Opportunity points equal to your level in this ability.

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Exploit</b>              | When you land a hit on a target with the Attack action, all subsequent attack checks made against that target gain a bonus modifier equal to your level in this ability until the end of your next turn.                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Mobility</b>             | <p>When you take an opportunity that isn't Combat Move in combat, you can move up to a short distance. When you make use of this ability, the next attack made against you before the start of your next turn is made at -1 disadvantage.</p> <p>You can use this ability a number of times equal to your level in this ability, and regain a use when you Recuperate.</p> |
| <b>Maximise Support</b>     | At the start of your turn, choose a number of targets you can sense equal to your level in this ability. The targets gain a bonus to modifiers equal to your level in this ability until the start of your next turn.                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Excellent Assistance</b> | When you use the Combat Assist opportunity you grant +2 Advantage, rather than +1. You can make use of this ability a number of times up to your level in this skill, and regain a use when you Recuperate.                                                                                                                                                                |

## Combat Archetypes & Archetype Abilities

There are many abilities that a character can wield which provide bonuses, features, and traits in and out of combat. There are no limits to what abilities a character can select; however, each ability belongs to a specific **Combat Archetype**.

Different cultures and groups may call them by other names, but the same approach to combat can be observed regardless. Each archetype has a number of abilities associated with it. The choice to specialise in a specific archetype or to diversify by taking abilities from several archetypes belongs to the player. Archetypes represent approaches to combat that supplement the character's class.

When a character selects an ability from an Archetype, they gain a **level** in that Archetype. **Each Archetype Ability can be used a number of times equal to 2 + the level in the Archetype the Ability is from.** The character regains uses of abilities from their archetypes when they **Recuperate**.

Each number of Archetype Ability uses is tracked individually per Archetype.

When selecting an ability from an Archetype for the first time, you may select **one** of the available levers associated with the Archetype.

There are **no** restrictions on selecting an ability from a given archetype. A character may combine abilities from each archetype, however the level for each archetype is tracked separately.

For example: A character with Dirty Fighter, Quick Teleport, and Undo Motion would have level 1 in Reaver and level 2 in Shifter, since Dirty Fighter is a Reaver ability and both Quick Teleport and Undo Motion are Shifter abilities.

## *The Reaper*

Berserkers, hellions, stormtroopers... the Reaper approaches combat with a single goal in mind: to attack. The Reaper aims to strike from any position, as often as possible. To face a character with this archetype is to constantly face the threat of harm, no matter the situation. Few archetypes are more lethal.

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### **Reaver Abilities**

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#### ***Savagery – Speed – Power – Instincts – Ruthlessness***

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|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Dirty Fighter</b>  | When taking the Hinder or Expose Opportunity in combat, you can make a free attack with a one-handed weapon. The attack has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Reaver.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Wide Attack</b>    | When taking the Attack opportunity with a Two-handed weapon, you can make a free attack against a creature within reach. The attack has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Reaver.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Get over Here!</b> | You throw a grappling hook, lasso, or weighted rope at a target within short range, on a successful Strength contest with the target, you pull them into close range as an opportunity. If the contest is successful, you can make a free attack with a one-handed weapon against the target as part of the opportunity. The attack has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Reaver. You must have an appropriate item in your inventory to utilise this ability. |
| <b>Quicksplash</b>    | When you take the Move Opportunity in Combat, you can make a free attack as part of that Opportunity either before or after you move. The attack has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Reaver. You must be wearing armour no heavier than Light to use this ability.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Wall of Blades</b> | When an opponent moves within close range, you can make a free attack against them. The attack has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Reaver.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Retaliation</b>    | When hit with a CQC weapon, you can make a free attack against the attacker. The attack has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Reaver. The effects of each attack is resolved simultaneously.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

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## *The Officer*

No venture is successful without someone ready to take command; whether its by force of will or by right, the Officer specialises in spurring others to take action. They might not be the ones to take centre stage, but either from the front or the rear, the Officer watches keenly to ensure that their team finds victory.

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### **Officer Abilities**

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#### ***Strategy – Leadership – Perception – Control - Initiative***

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**On my Command!** As an opportunity, you can allow a willing creature in combat to take the attack opportunity freely on your turn. If the attack hits, it has either +1 Advantage or +1 Severity at your discretion, decided before the check is made.

**Take Cover!** As an opportunity, select a number of willing creatures equal to your Intuition modifier other than you. The target(s) is considered to be within Light cover until the end of your next turn. This does not stack with other forms of cover.

**Bring it down!** As an opportunity, you can select a target and a number of willing creatures equal to your Intuition modifier, other than you. Each willing creature can make a single free attack at -1 advantage at the target, using whatever means they have available. The attack(s) has a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Officer.

**Strategic Mind** Gain either +1 to Intuition or +1 to Intellect, to a maximum of 10. This bonus is permanent and does not require the use of an ability to trigger.

**According to Plan** As an opportunity at the end of target's opportunity, if you succeed a check using your Intellect modifier, you can choose to undo the opportunity; this was all just part of your predictions.

A willing creature other than you within short range of you then gains a number of Opportunity points that they can use immediately equal to your level in Officer. If they do not use them immediately, they are lost.

The target may then take their opportunity a second time, if they so choose.

**Get back on your feet!** As an opportunity, select a willing creature. The creature can either take the Recuperate Opportunity or take the Move Opportunity at their discretion. This does not cost them any opportunities, though it will cost them a Recuperation point if they choose to recuperate.

**Get ready!** As an opportunity, select a willing creature. The creature immediately gains a number of Opportunity Points equal to your Officer level.

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## *The Shifter*

Not all magic is used for grand displays of power. By using magic to constantly stay in motion, even non-casters can introduce a frightening ability to control the situation they are in. Under their watchful eyes, every soldier will be where they are most needed, no friend will be in harms way, and every enemy will find their task a little harder.

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### **Shifter Abilities**

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#### ***Momentum – Ethereal Sight – Speed – Dimensional Knowledge - Position***

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|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Magic Shield</b>            | When not wearing armour, attacks targeting you have a malus to their attack roll equal to <b>your Controller Mage</b> level.                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Quick Teleport</b>          | You can teleport up to a short distance. If a creature within a short distance is willing, you can switch places.                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Shunt</b>                   | You can choose a willing creature other than yourself within medium range. The character can teleport up to a short distance.                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Deflect</b>                 | As an Opportunity, when you see a creature within medium range get hit by an attack, you can make an Arcanothurgy check. On a success, the attack misses. On a failure, all subsequent attacks against that creature have a malus to their attack checks equal to your level in Controller Mage. |
| <b>Lock Down</b>               | As an Opportunity, you can target a creature within medium range. On an Intellect Contest, the target cannot take the Move Opportunity until the end of your next turn.<br><br>If you have 2 or more levels in Controller Mage, the next attack against the target has +1 advantage.             |
| <b>Undo Motion</b>             | As an Opportunity, you move a creature within medium range to the position they had before taking a single Move opportunity they made after the end of your previous turn.                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Secondary Teleportation</b> | When you deal damage by any means, you can teleport up to a short distance.                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

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## *The Lucky Fool*

Not every individual is trained in combat, but the Lucky Fool doesn't need training; instead, their abilities either stem from a canny ability to position themselves so that failure doesn't affect them as badly, or were blessed with such fortune that they never needed training to start with.

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### **Lucky Fool Abilities**

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#### ***Luck – Wit – Initiative – Bravery – Fight or Flight Instinct***

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**Force Blunder** Your bad luck is infectious. When you see a creature make a check, you can impose -1 disadvantage on the check. If the check fails, you gain +1 advantage on your next check.

**Bard (Lucky Fool)** Choose up to 3 instruments; irrespective of any other skill or statistic, you are considered proficient at playing these instruments.

As an Opportunity in combat, you can choose a number of willing creatures that can hear you equal to your Lucky Fool level if you are wielding one of the selected instruments. The next check each of the willing creatures makes is done at +1 Advantage.

**Hidden Opportunity** When you fail a check of any sort in combat, you gain 1 Opportunity Point and make your next check before the end of your next turn with +1 advantage.

**Fortunate Dash** When you take the Move opportunity, attacks made against you until the start of your next turn have -1 disadvantage. If you are hit before the start of your next turn, you gain +1 Opportunity Points, and the effect ends early.

**Didn't Happen** When you make a check as part of a Basic Combat Opportunity and fail, you can immediately make a second Basic Combat Opportunity for free.

**Volatile Energy** When a creature triggers Volatility within short range, you can gain 2 Opportunity Points.

**Specialist Tools** When you gain access to this archetype ability, select a broad category of tools. You can choose to make an improvised attack with this tool, which counts as a weapon for you; work with your GM to determine the properties of the weapon. When making an attack using this type of tool as an improvised weapon, you gain +1 Advantage.

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## *The Expert*

Combat is a skill. Like any skill, it can be learned, practiced, and excelled at. The Expert hones their abilities to the peak of reliability. Duellists, sharpshooters, champion martial-artists... their basics are flawless, because when it comes to matters of life and death, reliability is how they survive.

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### **Expert Abilities**

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#### ***Specialist Knowledge – Training – Position – Mobility – Keen Eye***

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|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Expert Finesse</b>   | At the start of your turn, you can gain a bonus to all checks that use Combat Finesse until the end of your turn equal to your level in Expert.                                                                                                             |
| <b>Dual-Wielder</b>     | When making an attack with an off-hand weapon, you treat the second attack as normal, rather than apply -1 disadvantage.                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Armour-Breaker</b>   | When using a weapon that has the Anti-Armour property against an opponent wearing armour (or that features armour as part of their body) you gain a +2 bonus to succeed in attack checks as a modifier.                                                     |
| <b>Defensive Stance</b> | When you take the Mitigate basic combat opportunity, it costs 1 less Opportunity point than usual, to a minimum of 0.                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Peak Physique</b>    | Gain either +1 to Strength or +1 to Finesse, to a maximum of 10. This bonus is permanent and does not require the use of an ability to trigger.                                                                                                             |
| <b>On the Back Foot</b> | When you are making a check in combat at any level of disadvantage once all advantages and disadvantages are tallied, you can make the check with a bonus of +3.                                                                                            |
| <b>Duellist</b>         | When using a weapon with the Cutting property that doesn't have the Two-handed property, you add +2 to your checks as part of using that weapon as a modifier.                                                                                              |
| <b>Weapon Mastery</b>   | Select a specific type of weapon from the weapon list when you gain access to this ability. You can change the weapon type when finishing a Full Reset.<br><br>When you miss an attack with this weapon, you can make a second attack for free immediately. |

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## *The Slayer*

At the end of the day, it's the one who deals the most damage who wins the fight. These are the individuals who put it all on the line for a chance to deal serious damage. It's not about the quantity of hits they dish out, but the sheer overwhelming power.

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### **Slayer Abilities**

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#### ***Power – Determination – Focus – Killer Instinct – Strategy***

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|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Where it Hurts</b> | When you deal damage by any means against a target that is under the effect of Expose, your attack deals an additional 1 Severity.                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Power Stance</b>   | If you have not taken the move opportunity on your previous turn, when you deal damage, when dealing damage via any means, you deal additional severity equal to your level in Slayer. You are unable to take the Move opportunity until the start of your next turn.          |
| <b>Pain to Power</b>  | When you deal damage against a target after taking damage from an attack after the end of your last turn, the damage you deal by any means gains +1 Severity.                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Marked</b>         | Select a number of targets you can sense within a Long range equal to your level in Slayer. Until the end of the scene, you gain a +1 modifier to all checks against that target as part of opportunities taken on your turn.                                                  |
| <b>Stealth Attack</b> | Any damage dealt by any means made against a target that considers you concealed at any level has an increased severity score of 1.                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Rage!!!</b>        | At the start of your turn, damage you deal by any means deals +1 severity and attack checks you make have a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Slayer.<br><br>However, all attacks made against you also have a bonus to the modifier equal to your level in Slayer. |

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## *The Tower*

The first rule of combat is to not die. The tower is a specialist at standing within the maelstrom of danger and staying alive. Those they protect may conceal themselves in the shadow of their protection, taking shelter in the strength they provide.

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### **Tower Abilities**

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#### ***Resilience – Training – Momentum – Bulk – Control***

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|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Made of Iron</b>      | As an opportunity, you can regain uses of your Armour equal to your Tower level.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Deflect</b>           | When taking damage with a severity higher than 1 whilst in a combat encounter, you can reduce the severity to 1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Get behind me!</b>    | As an opportunity, all creatures of your choice within close range count as being in Moderate cover.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Bodyguard</b>         | When a target you can sense is hit by an attack in combat, you move up to your movement speed towards them and if you end your movement within reach, you take the outcome of the hit.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Priority Target</b>   | You become the priority target for a single enemy within close range you can sense if you pass a check using your Defence or Combat Finesse skill. If you pass, if the target has the ability to attack you, it will choose to do so instead of choosing another target; the target has a malus to any attack made against you until the end of your next turn equal to your Tower level. |
| <b>Protective Prayer</b> | You pray to a higher or lower power to protect a target you can sense (including yourself). The target gains the effects of Moderate Cover until the start of your next turn. This does not stack with other forms of cover.                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Shield Fighter</b>    | A shield can be used to make a free attack, as per the rules of dual wielding.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

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## *The Enchanter*

Sometimes, attracting attention is in of itself an advantage. The Enchanter manipulates perception to their advantage, either by dint of their extravagant behaviour or with a touch of magic.

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### Enchanter Abilities

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#### *Trickery – Allure – Illusion – Insight – Truesight*

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|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Priority Target</b>   | You become the priority target for a number of enemies equal to your level in Enchanter within moderate range you can sense if you pass a check using your <b>Eloquence &amp; Oration</b> or <b>Deception &amp; Misdirection</b> skill. If you pass, if the target has the ability to attack you, it will choose to do so instead of choosing another target until the end of your next turn.                  |
| <b>Surprise Attack</b>   | When making an attack against a target that considers you concealed at any has an advantage of 1. If the attack hits, subsequent attacks made against you have a malus to the check equal to your level in Enchanter until the end of your next turn.                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Veil</b>              | Choose a willing creature within short range. That character benefits from Partial concealment until the end of your next turn. If you have level 3 in Enchanter, this becomes Full Concealment.                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Bard (Enchanter)</b>  | <p>Choose up to 3 instruments; irrespective of any other skill or statistic, you are considered proficient at playing these instruments.</p> <p>As an Opportunity in combat, you can choose a number of willing creatures that can hear you equal to your Enchanter level if you are wielding one of the selected instruments. The next check each of the willing creatures makes is done at +1 Advantage.</p> |
| <b>Fashion Defence</b>   | Whilst you are not wearing armour, you can use your Intuition statistic modifier instead of your Finesse modifier when dodging, if your Intuition statistic is higher. If the attack successfully lands, your use of this ability is refunded.                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Cutting Words</b>     | As an opportunity, you can take the Hinder action against a target you can sense; so long as your character is able to speak, and the target can hear you, you can take the Hinder action using your Intuition Statistic modifier and your Eloquence & Oration skill.                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Deflect Attention</b> | Choose a willing character within short range. Given the choice between making an offensive action against you or the target of this ability, enemies will choose to attack the target rather than you.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

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## *The Champion*

A champion is more than a simple fighter; they are exemplars, leading from the front and inspiring those around them with every action they take. Their successes spur those around them to even greater heights, and they serve as inspirations to all those who fight alongside them.

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### **Champion Abilities**

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#### *Inspirational Presence – Momentum – Leadership – Teamwork – Daring*

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|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Follow me!</b>             | When taking the Move opportunity, the champion can choose a number of willing creatures within short range equal to their level in Champion. These creatures can also take the Move action for free.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Whatever comes our way</b> | As an opportunity, you choose a number of willing creatures within short range equal to your level in Champion. The damage these creatures take until the end of your next turn is limited to a severity of 1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Against the tide</b>       | When you deal damage by any means, a number of willing creatures within short range equal to your level in Champion gain a bonus to all checks equal to your level in Champion.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Saviour</b>                | When a target you can sense is hit by an attack in combat, you move up to your movement speed towards them and if you end your movement within reach, you take the outcome of the hit.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Challenge!</b>             | <p>As an opportunity, you become the priority target for a single enemy within moderate range you can sense if you pass a check using your <b>Eloquence &amp; Oration</b> skill. If you pass, if the target has the ability to attack you, it will choose to do so instead of choosing another target until the end of your next turn.</p> <p>Until the end of your next turn, all attacks gain a malus equal to your Champion level.</p> |
| <b>Rally!</b>                 | As an opportunity in combat, choose a number of willing creatures equal to your Champion level. Each creature loses 1 Injury Point.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

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## *The Scout*

A scout is a veteran when it comes to operating independently and effectively. Equipped with tools to survive by themselves as well as inform and assist from a distance, it is the preference of this class of individual to be as far from danger as possible, yet have the greatest impact.

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### **Scout Abilities**

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#### ***Agility – Keen Eyes – Strategy – Survival Instincts – Silent Movement***

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|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Quick Disappear</b>   | As an opportunity, you move up to a short distance; until the end of your next turn, you gain Light concealment to all attackers from a distance greater than close range.                                                                                                             |
| <b>Animal Companion</b>  | You gain an animal companion. Work with your GM to design your animal companion; the animal companion is a Basic SNPC; refer to the Appendix for guides on how to design an animal companion.<br><br>If you have a level of 3 or higher in Scout, your animal companion becomes Elite. |
| <b>Target</b>            | When you deal damage to a target by any means, all subsequent attacks against the target have a bonus modifier equal to your level in Scout.                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Trained Combatant</b> | When taking the Hinder Opportunity in combat, you can make one free attack with a weapon. This attack has a bonus modifier equal to your level in Scout.                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Stealth Assault</b>   | As an opportunity, you gain Light concealment to all attackers from a distance greater than close range. Any attack you make against a target that considers you concealed at any level has a bonus to attack equal to your level in Scout until the end of your next turn.            |
| <b>Combat Medic</b>      | When using first-aid kits and advanced medical kit in combat on yourself, you gain +1 advantage on checks made to heal injuries.                                                                                                                                                       |

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## 8. Combat Rules

### Combat Rules Overview

Unlike most situations, combat has many actors, sources of harm, and competing mechanics that mean dedicated rules for combat is necessary. Simple combat situations, such as brawls with lone individuals or highly abstracted engagements such as navigating a trench under an artillery fire may not necessitate these rules, and it is more expeditious to resolve such encounters using normal checks.

Combat makes the assumptions that all combatants are actively trying to suppress each other's actions. In order to enable more granular decisions, the concept of opportunities is expanded in combat encounters from a simple 3 tier system as described in Opportunities & Restriction.

As normal, actions can only be taken by seizing **opportunities**. The ability for each character to take opportunities is determined by how many **Opportunity Points** they have, which a character gains and spends throughout combat.

### Opportunity Points

By default, characters start combat with 0 opportunity points. At the start of a character's turn, a character can gain Opportunity Points based on how many Opportunities they took on their previous turn:

- On their first turn in combat, they gain **1** opportunity point.
- If they used 3 opportunity points on their last turn, they gain **no** opportunity points.
- If they used either 1 or 2 opportunity points on their last turn, they gain **2** opportunity points.
- If they used no opportunity points on their last turn, they gain **1 + 1d6** Opportunity points.

**Unless specified in the description of a given ability or opportunity, opportunities taken on a character's turn cost 1 opportunity point. Opportunities taken not on the character's turn cost 2 opportunity points.**

Opportunities can also be taken between turns or in response to a specific trigger (described in the ability itself). When two characters want to take an opportunity between a turn or in response to the same trigger, the character that is first in the turn order resolves their opportunity first.

### Turn Order

At the start of combat, all participants (both player and non-player) roll 3d6 and add either their Finesse or Intuition modifier. The participants are then sorted based on the number they rolled, with the highest scores going first.

In the event of a tie, player characters go before non-player characters. The players then determine which goes first by mutual agreement or coin-flip. The GM then arranges the non-player characters as they wish.

### Making an Attack

Ubiquitous to combat is the concept of making an attack. This is a basic attempt to cause harm to another using the weapons and abilities available to a character (such as a sword, gun, or fist).

Making an attack is done the same way as any check; by rolling **3d6** and aiming to get **11** or higher on the total.

In close-quarters combat, **Strength** is used as a modifier for checks made with weapons unless the weapon specifies that it is an Agile weapon, in which case, **Finesse** is used as a modifier instead.

In ranged combat, **Finesse** is used as a modifier unless the weapon is thrown, in which case it uses either **Strength** or **Finesse**, at the thrower's discretion.

If the check passes, the attack is successful. Every attack has a severity of 1 by default.

## Avoiding Harm

There are 3 ways to avoid taking damage by default; using **armour**, **dodging**, or utilising **cover / concealment**.

### *Armour*

A character wearing armour can choose to not take damage from a successful attack a number of times per combat. Armour can be either **light** or **heavy**. **Different levels of armour have different numbers of uses.**

- Heavy armour enables a character to negate the effects of a successful attack 3 times, plus the character's **Defence** skill level. A character cannot dodge whilst wearing heavy armour.
- Light armour enables a character to negate the effects of a successful attack a number of times equal to the character's **Defence** skill. A character can still dodge whilst wearing light armour, but they must add +1 to the dodge roll whilst wearing light armour.

A character wearing armour regains the all uses of their armour at the end of the scene.

Armour by default can only protect against physical damage from attacks, not elemental damage such as fire, cold, pressure, or electricity.

### *Dodging*

A character can try to dodge a successful attack made against them. The character rolls a d6; if the result is equal to or above their Dodge Score, then the effect is successfully negated.

The character's dodge score can be calculated 2 ways:

- By taking 6 minus the character's Finesse modifier, **or**
- By taking 6 minus the character's Defence skill.

A character cannot dodge when subjected to an area of effect attack (such as an explosion), when they are immobilised or otherwise unable to move, and when they are wearing heavy armour. A roll of 1 will always result in a failed dodge.

### *Cover / Concealment*

When your character is in cover or is obscured, there is a chance that ranged attacks may fail against you. Functionally, cover works in the same manner as concealment, as in both cases there is a chance the ranged attack will miss the target, irrespective of whether the attack hits cover or misses due to poor visibility.

When benefitting from cover or concealment and a successful attack is made against you, roll a d6. If the score is equal to or above the target score, the attack fails.

| Cover Level / Concealment Level   | Target Score |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|
| Light cover / Partial Concealment | 5 - 6        |
| Moderate Cover                    | 4 - 6        |
| Heavy Cover / Full Concealment    | 3 - 6        |

**Light cover** corresponds to structurally weak or ramshackle cover not intended for use as defences or if heavily damaged (such as an improvised barricade or a farm fence).

**Moderate cover** corresponds to structurally sound cover that covers a substantial portion of the body (such as a stone wall or crenelation).

**Heavy cover** corresponds to strong fortifications designed to withstand assault (such as a concrete bunker or being within an armoured vehicle).

**Partial Concealment** refers to when portions of your body are obscured, blurred, or indistinct (such as when behind foliage or in fog).

**Full concealment** refers to heavy obscuration to complete invisibility.

A character cannot benefit from both cover and concealment at the same time with regards to utilising the concealment and cover mechanics.



## Combat Movement

In combat, a character can move up to a **short (20 m)** distance.

Alternatively, they can move a **medium (50 m)** distance at the cost of an additional opportunity point.

When moving through any terrain in which their movement would be substantially reduced (such as through water, or climbing up a cliff, or navigating razor wire) their maximum movement is halved.

## Recuperation in Combat

In combat, in addition to any additional effects Recuperation offers with regards to regaining uses of abilities (specified in the ability description), the character loses 1d6 injury points. This does not remove existing injuries taken.

## Reach and Range

When making an attack or taking a hostile action, the target must be within reach (in the case of close-quarters combat) or within range (for ranged combat).

Reach is given as your characters maximum dimension in any direction halved, + 1 metre. This is always rounded up to the nearest metre, and represents a standard lunge.

Range is given in the description of the ranged weapon you are using.

## Dual Wielding Weapons

When wielding a second weapon, when making an attack, choose which weapon is your primary weapon and secondary weapon. As part of an attack opportunity made with your primary weapon, you can make a free attack using your secondary weapon at -1 disadvantage.

## Shields

Wielding a shield counts as being in Light cover. This does not stack with other forms of cover.

## Reloading

After finishing an opportunity using a weapon with this property roll a d6 all weapons used as part of the opportunity. If the score is equal to or above the reload score (indicated in brackets) the weapon must be reloaded before using it offensively again. You will be required to have ammunition of the appropriate type to reload the weapon. A reload score of 1 indicates that the weapon must always be reloaded after firing.

Opportunities that require making a Reload roll are attacking, hindering, exposing, or any other action that involves making an attack check with the weapon unless it states otherwise.

## Basic Combat Actions

The following are actions that every character can make; each costs an opportunity unless an ability specifies they can be used for free.

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Attack</b>               | Attack a target within range that you can sense using the Making an Attack rules.                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Combat Move</b>          | Move as per the Combat Movement rules.                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Recuperate</b>           | The character expends a Recuperation point as per the Recuperation rules.                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Defend</b>               | When a target other than you within reach is hit with a successful attack, make a check using your <b>Defence</b> skill. On a success, the attack severity is reduced by your Defence skill.          |
| <b>Combat Assist</b>        | Choose a target within range. The next time the target makes an attack before the start of your next turn, they gain +1 advantage.                                                                    |
| <b>Hinder</b>               | Choose a target within range and make a check using the <b>Combat Finesse</b> skill. On a success, the target loses a number of opportunity points equal to 1 + the character's Combat Finesse skill. |
| <b>Expose</b>               | Choose a target within range and make a check using the <b>Combat Finesse</b> skill. On a success, attacks made against the target until the start of your next turn gain +1 advantage.               |
| <b>Disarm</b>               | Choose a target within range and make a check using the <b>Combat Finesse</b> skill. On a success, a single weapon that is equipped by the target is dropped.                                         |
| <b>Exacerbate</b>           | When you make a successful attack, you can increase the severity by 1.                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Mitigate</b>             | When a successful attack is made against you, you can reduce the severity by 1 to a minimum of 1.                                                                                                     |
| <b>Equip / Unequip Item</b> | You can exchange an item in your hand with one in your inventory or pick an item up. The items can be reasonably grouped (such as a quiver or a set).                                                 |
| <b>Interact</b>             | You interact with an item or element of the environment in order to produce an effect.                                                                                                                |

## Weapons

All weapons follow the same basic rules. If a weapon is dangerous enough to constitute a harm, then by default it has a severity of 1. However, not all weapons have the same properties.

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>One-handed</b>   | The weapon can be wielded comfortably in one hand, leaving the other hand free to wield another one-handed weapon, or hold another object such as a shield.                                                                                |
| <b>Two-handed</b>   | The weapon is too large to be wielded in one hand and requires two to use effectively. However, it is more powerful. When taking the Exacerbate opportunity, the severity increases by 2, instead of 1.                                    |
| <b>Anti-Armour</b>  | The weapon is especially effective against armoured opponents. When a target uses armour to negate the attack, it costs 2 uses of the armour property instead of 1.                                                                        |
| <b>Cutting</b>      | The weapon is especially effective against unarmoured opponents. When a target has no uses of their armour remaining or are not wearing armour, attacks made with this weapon deal +1 severity.                                            |
| <b>Agile</b>        | The weapon can use your Finesse modifier instead of your Strength modifier.                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Reload</b>       | This weapon uses ammunition of some form in order to function and uses the Reloading rules.                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Heavy Weapon</b> | This weapon is considered too heavy to be considered conventional. When using a heavy weapon, movement is halved, however all attacks made with the weapon are done at +1 severity. This weapon uses the Heavy Weapon Operation skill.     |
| <b>Weak</b>         | This weapon is underpowered. If it deals damage of severity 2 or higher after all other effects are accounted for, it deals 1 less severity.                                                                                               |
| <b>Range</b>        | Ranged weapons have a range; this is the maximum range at which they can realistically hit a target. Unless the ranged weapon has the Short Range property it has -1 disadvantage against targets within close range of the wielder (2 m). |

### *Unarmed Combat*

When making an attack with no weapons, the severity of all attacks is limited to 1.

However, unarmed attacks that have this limitation also reduce the opportunity points of the target by 1.

Unarmed attacks use the Martial Arts skill modifier.

## 9. Injuries & Recovery

### Injuries & Recovery Overview

Putting oneself in harms way is dangerous. Injuries sustained during a scenario can range from painful inconveniences to life-ending events. Injuries can occur after being exposed to hazards, being attacked in combat, or as a result of adverse events.

Each character **injury points** that are gained when an effect with a severity of 1 or higher is inflicted onto a character. The number of injury points a character has at any time must be tracked. When the number of injury points a character has equals or exceeds the **injury threshold** of the character, the character gains an **Injury**.

Injuries are debilitating, and should be treated as soon as possible. When a character gains an injury, it affects an **anatomical location**.

**Physical damage and exposure to elemental damage (such as fire, cold, energy, pressure) causes injury to an external region. Toxins, diseases, curses, and parasites cause injury to an internal system.**

Injuries stack with each other. When receiving a second injury to the same location whilst an existent injury is already active, the injury worsens. All injuries start as **minor injuries**. Minor injuries progress to **permanent injuries**, which progress into **fatal injuries**.

|                 | Location                                               | Injury                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>External</b> | Head (Eyes, Skull, Ears, Face, Brain)                  | Injured Head                      |
|                 | Throat (vocal chords, windpipe, artery)                | Injured Throat                    |
|                 | Upper Torso (Ribs, Lungs, Heart, Stomach)              | Injured Chest                     |
|                 | Lower Torso (Intestines, Stomach, Reproductive Organs) | Injured Lower Body                |
|                 | Arms                                                   | Injured Arm                       |
|                 | Legs                                                   | Injured Leg                       |
| <b>Internal</b> | Cardiovascular System                                  | Compromised Cardiovascular System |
|                 | Central Nervous System                                 | Nervous Damage                    |
|                 | Immune System                                          | Compromised Immune System         |
|                 | Respiratory System                                     | Difficulty Breathing              |
|                 | Digestive System                                       | Bad Digestion                     |
|                 | Musculoskeletal System                                 | Weakened                          |

The GM can determine whether the targeted location is external, or a system. Then, the GM rolls a 1d6 to determine the location of the injury, unless an effect targets a specific location.

## Injury Levels

There are 3 injury levels; **temporary**, **permanent**, and **fatal**.

### *Minor Injuries (Temporary)*

A **minor** injury incurs a penalty as described in the penalty column to the associated anatomical location. The GM can leverage this at their discretion to incur -1 disadvantage, or use it as the basis for an adverse event. Once a minor injury is used as the basis of an adverse event, the injury disappears as it fades away naturally or is **recovered**.

A minor injury will fade away naturally after 1d6 scenes.

### *Permanent Injuries*

A **permanent** injury works the same as a minor injury, with the exception that it can be used as the basis of an adverse event indefinitely until it is **recovered**.

### *Fatal Injuries*

A **fatal** injury means there is an immediate risk to the life of the character who sustains it. A fatal injury may include the destruction, amputation, or the shutdown of a key anatomical region.

When an anatomical region sustains a fatal injury, the character is rendered unconscious and will die at the end of the subsequent scene if their condition is not **stabilised** or **recovered**.

### *Medical Complications*

**If an adverse event occurs as part of the recovery of a fatal injury, the affected body part (or a specific region; see anatomical location table) is either partially or totally lost, or otherwise rendered nonfunctional permanently.**

The character will need to source a prosthetic or long-term treatment (such as drugs) in order to recover their lost capabilities and function normally, or else the penalty from the injury recurs.

This effect cannot happen twice. If it occurs a second time, the character dies instantly.

*Note: In real life, destruction of a vital organ or complete loss of a vital function (such as the heart being unable to pump blood) does not lead to probable survivable outcomes for the durations supplied. These are selected for gameplay functions under the assumption that for the player character in question, they are the unusual statistic that is able to beat the odds provided they reach a medical facility.*

## Recovery

Minor injuries can be recovered using **First Aid kits**. First aid kits contain the necessary medical equipment to treat light injuries effectively, including bandages, sutures, and common drugs for most poisons and disease symptoms.

In addition, First Aid kits can **stabilise** a fatal injury, extending the duration before death by an additional scene, but do not cause recovery.

Permanent and Fatal injuries and higher can only be recovered using **Advanced medical kit**. These contain far more intensive equipment capable of performing advanced surgeries.

In order to successfully remove an injury, a character makes a **recovery check** using their **Medicine & Biology** skill.

A recovery check is required per injured anatomical location. After making a recovery check for a minor injury or to stabilise a fatal injury, roll a d6. On a 1, the first aid kit is lost. After making a recovery check for a permanent or fatal injury, roll a d6. On a 1-3, the advanced medical kit is lost.

Recovering in the field is **volatile**. Recovery done in a dedicated medical facility is not.

## 10. Resets

### Minor Reset

A minor reset is an opportunity for characters to breathe, destress, and tend to minor scrapes and bruises.

When a character takes a minor reset, at least **one** of the following conditions must be applicable to **each** character:

- The character is able to unwind without the threat of danger
- The character has the time and ability to tend to their health
- The character has the time and ability to close their eyes and rest for a time.

A group can only perform a Minor Reset once per scene.

At the end of a Minor Reset, the characters:

- Lose 1 stress
- Regain 1 recuperation point
- Lose 1d6 injury points

### Full Reset

A full reset allows characters time to fully tend to their injuries and prepare. In order to take a full reset, at least **one** of the following conditions must be applicable to **each** character:

- The character is able to get a full, restful sleep
- The character is able to tend to their injuries and be taken care of meaningfully
- The character is able to fully decompress, meditate, and reflect on traumatic events.

A group can only perform a full reset once per scene. If a full reset is interrupted, but the conditions for a Minor Reset are satisfied, the group benefits from the effects of a minor reset instead.

At the end of a Full Reset, the characters:

- Lose 1d6 stress.
- Regain 1d6 recuperation points.
- Lose all their injury points.

# 11. Navigation & Hazards

## Overview

Beyond combat, the most frequent type of dangers a party will face will be environmental. Machinery can explode, artillery shells can land near the party, poisonous plants can emit deadly gas, and even a muddy slope can lead to a fatal fall.

When exploring, whether it's on foot, in a vehicle, climbing or swimming, a character is likely exposed to one or more **hazards**.

A hazard is a source of harm. Hazards all have the capacity to cause damage.

When a character is exposed to a hazard, it is called a **hazardous situation**.

## Hazards & Hazardous Situations

A hazardous situation is when one or more **hazards** are exposed to the characters. When there is a realistic sequence of events that can lead to the hazard causing harm to the character, this is called a hazardous situation. Examples of hazards and hazardous situations include:

|                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Falling/Drops:</b>                | A character slips and falls from a height; the ground is unstable and may collapse into a pit                                                                                                             |
| <b>Energy/Electricity/Lightning:</b> | Live wires come into contact with a character as they explore; a lightning strike shocks a character in a storm                                                                                           |
| <b>Fire/Heat:</b>                    | Open flames burn a character; the heat from a vent burns a character nearby; the character touches heated metal plates                                                                                    |
| <b>Ice/Cold:</b>                     | A character is exposed to excessive cold for a long duration/A character comes in contact with a supercooled piece of arcanotech                                                                          |
| <b>Noise/Vibration:</b>              | A loud noise erupts near the character, potentially causing damage to the ears; the character is exposed to constant vibration near an engine                                                             |
| <b>Sharp Edges/Cuts:</b>             | A character is exposed to numerous sharp glass shards from the wasteland; A character comes into contact with a sharp mechanism whilst exploring a ruin; a character triggers a trap that contains blades |
| <b>Poison:</b>                       | A character breathes in poisonous fumes from a machine; a character is injected with poison from a toxic plant                                                                                            |
| <b>Radiation:</b>                    | A character is exposed to magical radiation from an ancient experiment; a character suffers from prolonged exposure to a deadly emission from the Dark Zone                                               |
| <b>Impacts:</b>                      | A heavy rock falls on a character; a crushing body of water impacts the character                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Suffocation/Drowning:</b>         | A character enters a region with little or no oxygen; a character becomes trapped underwater                                                                                                              |

**Disease:** A character is exposed to a deadly disease from a corpse; a character is exposed to a deadly disease from a laboratory

**Dehydration / Starvation / Fatigue:** A character is exposed to excessive hunger for a prolonged duration; a character is exposed to intensely dry environments for a prolonged duration; a character becomes worn out due to excessive strain

In most cases, a character will not choose to willingly expose themselves to a hazard. Therefore, under most circumstances whether a hazard will cause harm to a character as part of a hazardous situation comes down to a Burden of Failure check done by the GM.

The GM can roll the check any time a specific action or event triggers a fresh exposure to the hazard, or if the hazard exists passively during the scene at all times, once per scene.

The GM may refer to the rules for determining check complexity when determining if an action taken by players may increase the complexity of the check when it comes to determining if a harm occurs.

## Hazard Severity & Tension

By default, the severity of an environmental hazard is 1. The GM may increase severity as a result of volatility, as normal.

Optionally, the GM may choose to implement **Tension**. Tension increases as a result of failed Burden of Success checks. For every 2 BS checks that are failed as part of a scene, the tension increases by 1. For every level of tension, the severity dealt by hazards within the scene increases by 1.

Tension starts at level 0 at the start of a scene by default.

## Movement & Navigation

Outside of combat, navigation and movement as part of exploration operates by abstracted speed and time.

There are, in a standard day, 6 distinct ‘**periods**’.

**Noon** A ‘quick travel’ is any period of travel that does not progress the period of day. A ‘long travel’ is any period of travel that progresses the period by 1 category.

**Afternoon – Evening**

**Evening – Early Night** Since speed is determined not just by the maximum possible speed of the character, vehicle, or creature, but also the **terrain, train schedules, ability to navigate, and breaks taken** to traverse the terrain, no creature or device has a set distance they can travel within a given time.

**Midnight**

**Late Night – Dawn** When two characters are **racing** to reach the same destination across the same terrain, they can resolve this using a **check**.

**Dawn - Morning**



## 12. Social Interaction

### Skills and Social Interaction

Eventually, the player characters are likely going to have to talk to someone, unless they stay in the wastelands forever.

Fundamentally, how a non-player character interacts with player characters is down to how the GM interprets that character's behaviour. However, checks may enable characters to present information to a non-player character in a specific way.

**Eloquence & Oration** is used to present information in a coherent manner. A well-presented argument will appear logical and sensible, even if it does not please the recipient.

**Deception & Misdirection** can convince a non-player character that something that is false is true, and that something true is false.

**Acting & Performance** can convince a character that they are someone they are not; this may be a specific individual or simply to adopt traits that are advantageous to the discussion.

**People Reading** can grant insight on what a character is thinking in a broad sense. It can provide information in the form of hunches, taking note of body language, and general demeanour.

Actions will always be more impactful to non-player characters than words, but words can alter the context of what a non-player character perceives in the moment.

### Manipulating non-Player Characters

Manipulating is not inherently malicious; in this context, manipulating means convincing, coercing, or otherwise managing to use words to get a character to behave a way they otherwise wouldn't.

This is done by a normal check; this means as per the check rules that an NPC can only be convinced to take action in this way if the outcome is uncertain. A character that is impossible to be convinced of a course of action requires no check, and neither does a character who was always going to do the action anyway.

When making the check, how the NPC perceives the player character matters. In particular, consider their **Objective Alignment** and **Emotional Disposition**.

**Objective Alignment** refers to the NPC's logical alignment with the player character; how well their objectives align, whether their interests benefit theirs, or whether their factions are aligned. Note: this is based on the NPCs beliefs at the time. They may be mistaken.

**Emotional Disposition** refers to how the NPC feels towards a character on an emotional level. Love, hatred, amusement, admiration... these matter when convincing a character of taking a course of action even if it is not in their best interests and they know it.

### *Objective Alignment Table*

|                         |                                                                                                                                    |                 |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Heavily Opposed</b>  | The character's interests run completely counter to the players; realistically, they are mutual obstacles to one another's success | +2 Disadvantage |
| <b>Somewhat Opposed</b> | The character's interests are hindered by the party                                                                                | +1 Disadvantage |
| <b>Neutral/Unknown</b>  | The character either doesn't know what the character's interests are, or doesn't believe they either hinder or help their schemes  | None            |
| <b>Somewhat Aligned</b> | The character believes that the party might be a help, even if they're not fully aligned                                           | +1 Advantage    |
| <b>Heavily Aligned</b>  | The character believes that the party has the same goal as them, or otherwise believes they have the same interests at heart       | +2 Advantage    |

### *Emotional Disposition Table*

|                             |                                                                                                                                                            |                 |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Intense Dislike</b>      | The character fundamentally does not like interacting with the player or party and would prefer they disappear.                                            | +2 Disadvantage |
| <b>Somewhat Dislike</b>     | The character does not enjoy interacting with the player or party and is keen for it to go on for no longer than necessary.                                | +1 Disadvantage |
| <b>Neutral</b>              | The character does not care for the player or party, but does not dislike them notably either.                                                             | None            |
| <b>Somewhat Appreciate</b>  | The character enjoys interacting with the player or party and enjoys their company when it happens.                                                        | +1 Advantage    |
| <b>Extreme Appreciation</b> | The character has a strong affinity for the player or party; they enjoy interacting with the party and would like for them to be together more frequently. | +2 Advantage    |

In some cases a faction's disposition and objective alignment may be substituted for a non-player character's personal situation.

## 13. Curses

### Curses Overview

Some curses are **permanent**, such as those granted by a Mystical nature. These cannot be cured. Other curses, such as those applied by Abominations can be resolved killing or entreating with the creature that made the curse. Once per scene, the GM can ask a character with a curse the following question:

**Are you in control?**

If the player replies ‘yes’, they gain +1 stress.

If the player answers ‘no’, they fill up a **curse counter**. The curse counter goes from 0 to 5. Once the counter reaches 3, one of the following effects occurs depending on the curse type. The curse counter is reset to 0 when the character makes a Full Reset.

### Curses

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Beast:</b>       | <p>You are replaced with a Beast that operates purely by fight or flight instinct. The beast behaves as per the Beast profile in the Appendix and is under the GM’s control.</p> <p>If the Beast gains injuries up to their Injury Threshold they do not die; they instead are replaced again with the cursed character, who is still suffering their Breakdown until the end of the scene.</p> |
| <b>The Premonition:</b> | <p>The GM grants you a premonition of something that will occur within 1d6 scenes. The GM will pose the player a question as per <b>the Adverse Event</b> rules. This adverse event will happen within 6 scenes. The GM determines when to apply the adverse event.</p>                                                                                                                         |
| <b>The Wasting:</b>     | <p>Your lifespan shortens by 10 years, and you suffer 1d6 injury points due to stress to your body.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>The Whispers:</b>    | <p>You hear whispers from an eldritch source in your mind. For the remainder of the scene, you gain the <b>Eldritch Advice</b> lever, but you trigger adverse events on any volatility check as the eldritch voice seeks to trick you.</p>                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>The Loneliness:</b>  | <p>For the remainder of the scene, when you touch someone other than you that you like their lifespan shortens by a year for every minute you touch them. They do not age noticeably, but come closer to death. They take 1 stress for every time you touch them, even inadvertently.</p>                                                                                                       |
| <b>The Vanishing:</b>   | <p>You can no longer touch or interact with things. Other characters cannot hear or see you. You cannot be harmed. This effect lasts until the end of the scene.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>The Loss:</b>        | <p>Who do you care for? If the character is present in the scene, they either suffer 1d6 injury points from a random accident or attacks against them have +1 advantage until the end of the scene. If you choose nobody or they are not present in the scene, you suffer a breakdown.</p>                                                                                                      |

|                               |                                                            |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>                  | <b>The Beast</b>                                           |
| <b>Tier:</b>                  | Elite                                                      |
| <b>Primary<br/>Statistic:</b> | Strength (+3)                                              |
| <b>Ability:</b>               | <b>Manslayer</b>                                           |
| <b>Loadout:</b>               | Claws (one-handed, cutting)<br>Claws (one-handed, cutting) |

## 14. Non-Player Characters

### Non-Player Characters Overview

Throughout the game the player characters will interact with various other characters under the GM's control: **non-player characters**, or NPCs. These characters have their own wants and desires, and often will come into conflict with the player characters.

There are two types of NPC; major NPCs, and simplified NPCs.

### Major NPCs

Major NPCs are important characters that are expected to have significant input into the scenario. They will need their own skills, talents, abilities, and natures in order to have access to the full range of mechanics required to perform in the scenario.

Major NPCs are made using the same rules as player characters (see Character Creation & Player Mechanics), with the following adjustments:

- NPCs do not need motivations
- NPCs do not require Fate Points or Stress to be tracked.

NPCs also may have any additional feature or trait that the GM requires for them to have access to in order to represent them. NPCs are not as beholden to the rules as player characters are, and may have additional abilities as is required of them.

### Simplified NPCs

Most common soldiers, commoners, bandits, and ambulant monsters and animals do not require the full range of abilities and rules and are considered **Simplified NPCs** (SNPC). The rules they have access to are greatly reduced in order to make them faster to include in the game and control as a GM.

There are 2 tiers of simplified NPC; **basic** and **elite**.

Simplified NPCs require only the following:

- Their **tier**
- Their **primary statistic** (Strength, Finesse, Intuition, Intellect)
- A single **ability** (see Combat Archetypes & Archetype Abilities)
- Their **loadout**

### *SNPC Statistics*

By default, every SNPC has 6 for each statistic attribute, except for their **primary statistic**.

- For basic SNPCs, their **primary statistic** is equal to 8.
- For elite SNPCs, their primary statistic is equal to 10.

### *SNPC Abilities*

SNPCs have access to a single ability. This ability is sourced from the abilities list (see Combat Archetypes & Archetype Abilities) or a class ability (Such as Arcane Spellcasting or Seize Opportunity).

The ability an SNPC has access to contributes significantly to how they behave in combat.

If a SNPC has a class ability, it is treated as the equivalent level of that ability as the class would have access to at level 1 if the SNPC is of basic tier, or level 2 if they are of Elite tier.

### *SNPC Loadout*

Each SNPC has access to, by default, a single weapon or natural attack capable of causing harm. This may be changed by the GM to be a weapon with any combination of properties, as well as armour.

### *SNPC Injury Points*

Basic SNPCs have an Injury Threshold of 3. Elite SNPCs have an Injury Threshold of 5.

When a SNPC reaches their Injury Threshold, they do not take an injury; they are instead removed from play, either killed, knocked unconscious, or sufficiently injured as to no longer pose a threat.

## 15. Abominations

### Overview

Abominations do not have a set shape, form, or behaviour; they are defined by the unusual abilities they are able to bring to bear. The only constant is the base understanding that, in order to maintain these abilities, they need to have access to the ability via an organ, mechanism, item, or component. These are referred to as **cores**.

Abominations have two difficulty tiers; Minor Abominations and Major Abominations.

Minor Abominations are deadly, powerful monsters that can ruin a group of adventurers if they are not prepared. A Major Abomination dominates the scene they are in.

*Note: It is not recommended to have more than one Abomination present in a scene at a time, because there will be few survivors.*

Fighting an Abomination is not like fighting any other kind of opponent; abominations, due to their power, loathsomeness, and oppressiveness cause mental fatigue just to keep up with. They are monsters.

Each Abomination has a **Class**, and a number of **Cores**.

In combat, Abominations do not roll for to determine their place in the turn order. Instead, they take their turn at the **start** of the turn order, always. They do not have opportunities, instead, they either:

- Move up to a short distance (20 m) and can take an Abomination Ability
- Move up to a medium distance (50 m)

Abominations cannot change the order they use their abilities once they have used all their abilities at least once. If the core that enabled the use of the ability is destroyed, then they move to the next ability in the list.

An abomination, if their Primary Core is going to be destroyed, can choose to sacrifice one of their other cores instead. They can do this once if they are a Minor Abomination, or twice if they are a Major Abomination.

### Abomination Class & Queries

Each Abomination has a class; this represents the brand of traumatic that facing this abomination is. At the **end** of a round, they ask one of the 3 queries to the player characters in the scene. For every round that one or more player characters answers ‘yes’, the abomination’s finale counter increases by 1 (from 0).

At the start of every turn, the abomination rolls a d6. If the result is equal to 7 – the Finale Counter, then they perform their **finale**. The abomination can only perform the finale once per scene.

Every time a character answers ‘no’, they can choose to either take a Stress level or gain an Injury Point.

|                 |                                       |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>VILE Abomination</b>               |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i><b>Do you deserve this?</b></i>    |
|                 | <i><b>Do you hate your shape?</b></i> |
|                 | <i><b>Do you want to vomit?</b></i>   |

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Finale:</b> | The abomination chooses a character within the scene and rolls a d6. On a 1, the character mutates into a mound of flesh or some other hideous form; the condition is incurable. On any other result, they suffer a Breakdown and gain the <b>Mutated Form</b> penalty. |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>EXECUTOR Abomination</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i>Do you want to die?</i><br><i>Have you fought hard enough?</i><br><i>Are you ready for your next fight?</i>                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Finale:</b>  | The Abomination chooses a character and rolls a d6. On a 1, the character is instantaneously killed. On any other roll, the abomination chooses a character within the scene and instantly inflicts a life-threatening injury to them. |

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>ENVOIOUS Abomination</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i>Do you hate a friend?</i><br><i>Do they leave you out?</i><br><i>Do they whisper behind your back?</i>                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Finale:</b>  | The abomination chooses a character. The character suffers a Breakdown, but instead of being rendered inactive, is placed under the control of the abomination. The Abomination loses control over the character if the character successfully inflicts an injury to a fellow player character. |

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>OPPRESSIVE Abomination</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i>Do you feel like giving up?</i><br><i>Have you done enough?</i><br><i>Were your efforts wasted?</i>                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Finale:</b>  | The abomination chooses a character present in the scene. Roll a d6. On a 1, the character suffers a Breakdown and gains the <b>Lost Will</b> penalty. On any other roll, they lose all their Opportunity Points and gain the <b>Lost Will</b> penalty. |

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>ARROGANT Abomination</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i>Do you deserve more than this?</i><br><i>Are you worth more than your friend?</i><br><i>Do they not appreciate you?</i>                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Finale:</b>  | The abomination chooses a character. The character suffers a Breakdown, but instead of being rendered inactive, is placed under the control of the abomination. The Abomination loses control over the character if they suffer an injury. |

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>HATEFUL Abomination</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i>Do you resent what brought you here?</i><br><i>Is life unfair?</i><br><i>Do you want revenge?</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Finale:</b>  | The Abomination queries to a character of their choosing <i>Who do you want to hurt?</i><br><br>The target of the query can answer. If the answer is a character present in the scene other than the abomination, the Abomination inflicts a life-threatening injury to that character. Otherwise, they inflict a life-threatening injury to the character who answered the query. |



|                 |                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class:</b>   | <b>DESTROYER Abomination</b>                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Queries:</b> | <i>Should this place be wiped clean?</i>                                                                                                                       |
|                 | <i>Should we forget what happened here?</i>                                                                                                                    |
|                 | <i>Do you want to burn it all away?</i>                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Finale:</b>  | Every character in the scene gains 1d6 injury points, and the environment, if any still exists, is shattered, burned, or otherwise mangled by the Abomination. |

## Abomination Cores

Each Abomination, rather than sustaining injuries normally, sustains damage to Cores. Cores are an abstraction that serve simultaneously as targets for the player characters as well as the sources of abilities.

Each Core that an abomination has comes with an Abomination Ability. See Appendix: Abomination Cores for the list of abilities that a core can have.

Each core has an Injury Threshold of 5, except the **Primary Core**. The Primary Core has an Injury Threshold of 7. The Abomination dies when its Primary Core is destroyed or disabled.

**Minor Abominations have 3 cores (1 primary). Major Abominations have 6 (1 primary).**

Each core can be targeted in combat, and each core grants access to 1 Abomination Ability. The full list of Abomination Abilities can be found in the Appendix.

## Core Distribution

Some abominations will have a roughly humanoid shape. Others may have very unusual or unorthodox forms, and appear to the player characters as being a swarm, or part of the environment itself. The player characters might be fighting an abomination their size, albeit with superhuman powers, or they may be fighting on the back of the abomination itself.

The cores of an abomination may be clustered onto one ‘body’ or may be spread across an area. What is key is that each core can be targeted individually. When cores are separate, they can move independently of one another when they move at the start of the round.

## Multiple Abominations

It is not recommended for there to be multiple abominations present in a scene simultaneously, as this will result most likely in a complete annihilation of the player characters.

If such an unfortunate circumstance occurs, when Abomination Abilities conflict one another, the Major Abomination abilities take priority over Minor Abomination abilities, and takes their moves first. If Abominations are of the same tier, then the GM determines which abomination takes priority.



## 16. Inventory, Items, and Fortune

### Inventory

Characters can use, carry, and acquire **items**.

Items have 3 sizes; they can be **small**, **medium**, or **large**. This corresponds to a mixture of how heavy, cumbersome, and voluminous they are. Small items take up less space when carrying them than large ones.

**Small items take up 1 space. Medium items take up 3 spaces. Large items take up 6 spaces.**

**Items** are stored in a character's **inventory**. Inventory is a combination of the character's pockets, bags, specialised storage tools like holsters and scabbards, etc., and makes up their total storage capacity.

There are 2 types of inventory:

**Minor inventories** are small and non-obtrusive. There is no penalty for being equipped with a minor inventory. A character is **always** assumed to have a minor inventory when no other inventory is equipped, unless they are **functionally naked**.

**Minor inventories have up to 6 spaces.**

**Large inventories** are heavy enough to cause a character difficulty moving. In combat, a character has -3 to their modifiers when wearing a Large Inventory. Large inventories can be discarded as per the Don/DoFF opportunity. When equipped, a large inventory is tracked in **addition** to the character's minor inventory.

**Large inventories have up to 12 spaces.**

A character that discards their inventory loses access to the items inside that inventory. Items carried by hand or that are actively worn are **not** considered to be inside the inventory.

### Item Types

There are several basic categories of items.

**Components** are used for crafting. They are either natural (such as plants, wood, stone, organic matter) or artificial (screws, metal plates, springs, glass tubes).

**Weapons** are used for fighting. **One handed weapons** are considered **medium** items. **Two handed weapons** are considered **large** items.

**Worn items** are put on your body. They can be used for armour, fashion, or other utilities. Any worn item that is considered to be **light armour** or less protective is a **medium item**. Any worn item that has protective capacity above that is a **large item**.

**Utility items** are items such as torches, first aid kits, advanced medical kit, lockpicks, tools, ammunition, rations etc. are used for various tasks to assist or enable checks. Unless otherwise stated, they are **small** items.

**Junk** has no clear utility. Their size is variable.

**Components** and **tools** can be any of a certain type of component and are mechanically interchangeable. **Equipment**, unlike components, is just **one** of a given item. Examples are given in the table below.

The list provided below is not exhaustive of all possible items that can exist. As a rule of thumb, **Tools** have a cost score of 4 and are of medium size. **Equipment** can be any specialist item and typically has a cost score of 2 – 4.

## Fortune

Each character has Fortune Points. This represents their combined wealth and haggle ability. It is used for **paying for goods and services**.

| Cost Score | Description                                                                                                                          |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2          | Cheap expense; inexpensive meal, ammunition, non-negligeable travel fare, basic clothes, basic specialist equipment (rope, lanterns) |
| 4 - 6      | Moderate expense; non-specialist weapons (sword, rifle), expensive hotel, light armour                                               |
| 7 - 12     | Serious expense; specialist equipment (sniper rifle, artificer blade), heavy armour, luxury accommodation, bribing an official       |
| 13 +       | Massive expense; buying a vehicle, buying a house, bribing a politician                                                              |

When attempting to pay for any item or service, the character can roll a number of dice equal to their Fortune Points. If the sum total is above the Cost Score of the item or service, the exchange is successful.

For every d6 rolled that was equal to or below the cost score of the item / service, you lose a Fortune Point. If the exchange was not successful, you lose nothing.

If an exchange was unsuccessful, it cannot be reattempted until either the Cost Score of the item goes down (for example by haggling) or if you gain a Fortune Point.

## Selling Items

There are two ways of selling items; either by selling items that have a dedicated buyer, or by selling items in bulk as junk.

### *Selling Junk*

When selling items as junk, select a number of items you wish to sell, then roll a number of d6 equal to the number of items sold. For each 6 rolled, you gain a number of Fortune points. If you roll no sixes, the sale fails entirely; you keep all the items, but gain no Fortune; not even the pawn-shop owner wants your stuff.

Some merchants will have a limit on how much they can purchase in this way at a time; a small-time street vendor may only have room for 3 items (thus limiting the items you can select to 3), modest travelling caravans may be able to store 6, and shops might have room for up to 12.

### *Selling to a Dedicated Buyer*

Selling to a dedicated buyer means that your character has found a person or group of individuals who desire the item in question and are willing to pay, specifically, for that item. This may be a weapons collector looking to purchase a new sabre, or an arcanotechnician who wants to purchase a curio retrieved from the Dark Zone.

In such cases, the individual will grant the player character a number of Fortune points as if the player had gained fortune as a reward. The GM will determine an appropriate number of Fortune points, relative to the perceived cost of the item sold.

## Item List (Basic)

| Name                                  | Description                                                                             | Size   | Cost Score |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------|
| <b>Worn Items</b>                     |                                                                                         |        |            |
| <b>Clothing</b>                       | Used to protect the wearer's modesty, if they have any.                                 | Medium | 2          |
| <b>Fashionable Clothing</b>           | Used to champion the wearer's sense of fashion, if they have any.                       | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Protective Gear</b>                | Used to keep the wearer safe from a hazard. Does not include being attacked by weapons. | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Light Armour</b>                   | Used to protect the wearer from dying without encumbering them.                         | Medium | 6          |
| <b>Heavy Armour</b>                   | Used to protect the wearer a lot. Encumbers them.                                       | Large  | 12         |
| <b>Weapons</b>                        |                                                                                         |        |            |
| <b>One-handed (CQC) weapon</b>        | Used to kill people at short range.                                                     | Medium | 4          |
| <b>One-handed (Ranged) weapon</b>     | Used to kill people at long ranges.                                                     | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Two-handed (CQC) weapon</b>        | Used to kill people at short range. Takes up more space.                                | Large  | 6          |
| <b>Two-handed (Ranged) weapon</b>     | Used to kill people at long ranges. Takes up more space.                                | Large  | 6          |
| <b>Heavy Weapon (Ranged)</b>          | Used to kill freaks and destroy vehicles at long ranges.                                | Large  | 12         |
| <b>Shield</b>                         | A buckler, riot shield, or heater                                                       | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Utility</b>                        |                                                                                         |        |            |
| <b>Ammunition (One-handed Weapon)</b> | Fired by small-calibre weapons.                                                         | Small  | 1          |
| <b>Ammunition (Two-handed Weapon)</b> | Fired by heavier-calibre weapons                                                        | Small  | 1          |
| <b>Ammunition (Heavy Weapon)</b>      | Heavy duty ammunition.                                                                  | Small  | 2          |
| <b>First Aid Kit</b>                  | Used to patch up minor injuries.                                                        | Small  | 3          |
| <b>Advanced Medical Kit</b>           | Used to save lives.                                                                     | Small  | 5          |
| <b>Exploration Equipment</b>          | A torch, or pitons, rope, etc.                                                          | Small  | 2          |
| <b>Tailoring Tools</b>                | Includes needles, thread, staples, rivets                                               | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Chemistry Tools</b>                | Includes beakers, vials, burners                                                        | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Mechanical Tools</b>               | Includes hammers, spanners, screwdrivers                                                | Medium | 4          |
| <b>Rations</b>                        | Taste optional.                                                                         | Small  | 1          |
| <b>Components</b>                     |                                                                                         |        |            |
| <b>Artificial Components</b>          | Springs, metal tubes, screws, bolts...                                                  | Small  | 2          |
| <b>Natural Components</b>             | Roots, leaves, natural powders, herbs                                                   | Small  | 2          |

## 17. Improving & Crafting Items

It isn't uncommon for items found to have been customised, improved, altered, and enchanted.

Barring exceptional items that typically have narrative significance, most improvements can be categorised based on a simplified list of effects. The type of effects that may be applicable to an item may vary depending on the type of item being improved (typically CQC weapons, ranged weapons, and wearable items).

### Weapon Improvements:

- Balanced:** The weapon is especially easy to wield and gains a positive modifier when making attack checks with the weapon. The modifier bonus is equal to the level of this improvement (up to 3).
- Ornate:** The weapon is especially beautiful to look at. Whilst the weapon is sheathed/stowed, but visible, you can add +2 to a Social check. You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Lethal:** When you take the Exacerbate opportunity, the weapon deals an additional +1 severity. You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Combination:** This weapon is combined with a weapon of another type; the weapon's size is equal to the largest of the two weapon's sizes (one-handed or two-hander). Switching between the two weapons included in a Combination weapon does not require an action.
- Energised:** This weapon deals an amount of elemental damage on a successful hit. The damage is either fire, cold, or energy. You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Reliable:** If after summing up all advantages and disadvantages, you have a -1 Advantage on an attack check, you can instead roll as if you had 0 advantage. This does not apply on rolls with levels of advantage worse than -1.
- Vicious:** When dealing additional severity due to Volatility, add +1 severity.
- Cleaving:** If you succeed on an attack, you can make a second attack for free against a target within close range (2 m) of the first target for free.
- Increased Magazine:** When rolling to reload, if you roll a 1, you can roll again a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3). Only available to weapons with Reload.
- Explosive Charge:** On a successful hit, all creatures within short range (2 m) roll a d6. On a 1, they take a 1 severity harm. You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Repeating:** When rolling to reload, if you roll the maximum amount on the reload dice, you can make an additional attack as a free action. After making this free attack, you

must take an action to reload the weapon before you can use it again, as if you had rolled a 1. Only available to weapons with Reload.

- Long-range:** You can extend the range of the weapon by 1 category, but make the attack at -1 disadvantage.
- Close-range:** There is no minimum range for this weapon. Only available to weapons with a Minimum Range.
- Anti-cover:** When firing at a target in cover, the target counts as being in a level of cover lower than they are, to a minimum of Light Cover. Only available to Ranged weapons.

### **Worn Equipment Improvements:**

- Reinforced:** The armour or outfit is reinforced to help keep its wearer alive; for every level in this improvement (up to 3) gain 1 additional use of Armour.
- Beautiful:** The outfit is especially beautiful to look at. Whilst the worn item is worn and visible, you can add +2 to a Social check.  
You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Well Equipped:** The equipment comes with special tools and improvements to help accomplish tasks, such as accessible tools or hidden pockets containing diagrams. Select a skill from either the Intuition or Intellect based skills; when rolling a BS check for that skill, you can add +2 to the roll once.  
You regain a use of this ability once you Recuperate.
- Resistant:** The equipment is designed to protect against a specific type of elemental damage; either fire, cold, or energy. This worn item counts as a level of protection against that type of elemental damage for the purposes of resolving Burden of Failure checks against hazards.
- Reliable:** When taking damage from an attack in combat of Severity level 2 or higher, the severity level can be decreased by 1.  
You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.
- Stealthy:** When worn and whilst making a BS check involving moving unnoticed in darkness, you can gain +1 advantage to the check.  
You can make use of this property a number of times equal to the level of the improvement (up to 3) and regain a use when you Recuperate.

Items will have tiers of improvements that can be applied to them, that go from tier 1 to tier 5. An item will have as many improvements as it has tiers; therefore a tier 1 item will have 1 improvement, a tier 3 item will have 3, and a tier 5 will have 5. For every tier of weapon, the Cost Score of the item increases by 2.

Some improvements can be selected multiple times, increasing the level in said improvement. For example, a coat can have the Beautiful improvement selected twice, resulting in it having the Beautiful (2) improvement. This indicates the improvement level.

Some items will, instead of or on top of having improvements, have Flaws. Flaws are significant issues that the item has that make it difficult to use. A list of item flaws are provided below. For every flaw an item has, the Cost Score of the item decreases by 1.



### *Weapon Flaws:*

- Clumsy:** The weapon is difficult to wield and has a negative modifier when making attack checks with the weapon. The modifier malus is equal to the level of this flaw (up to 3).
- Harmless:** The weapon gains the Weak property. Only available to weapons that do not already have the Weak property.
- Fragile:** The weapon is easily damaged to the point of being rendered unusable. After a successful attack roll a number of d6 equal to the level of this flaw. On a 1 the weapon breaks and needs to be repaired, unjammed, or otherwise fixed.
- Personalised:** This weapon is difficult to use by anyone other than the person who made it or who modified it. If you are not experienced in using this specific weapon, you have -1 advantage when using the weapon to take hostile actions.
- Temperamental:** Before making an attack or taking a hostile action using this weapon, roll 1d6. On a 1, the action costs an additional opportunity. If the character does not have the required opportunity points, the action fails and cannot be made again until the start of your next turn.
- Oversized:** When stored in inventory, the weapon takes up additional inventory space equal to the level of this flaw (up to 3).
- Dangerous:** When making an attack or taking a hostile action using this weapon, roll a d6. On a 1, you gain an injury point.

### *Worn Equipment Flaws:*

- Fragile:** When taking damage in combat, roll 1d6 plus a number of d6 equal to the level of this flaw (up to 3). On doubles, the equipment breaks apart and becomes unusable until fixed. All benefits from wearing the equipment are lost until repaired.
- Ugly:** When making a BS social check whilst wearing this armour, roll a number of d6 equal to the level of this flaw (up to 3). If any of the rolls are a 1, you gain a -1 advantage on the roll.
- Oversized:** When stored in inventory, the item takes up additional inventory space equal to the level of this flaw (up to 3). Whilst worn, your maximum inventory space is reduced by 2.

**Unreliable:** When taking damage from a source of severity level 2 or higher, you take one severity.

**Obvious:** When attempting to move stealthily, you gain -1 advantage on any BS check made.

In general, by default for every 2 Improvements an item has, it will have 1 Flaw, but this is not a requirement. An especially well-crafted or enchanted item could be a valuable treasure for a party, enabling a player to overcome even deadlier threats.

## 18. Crafting Equipment & Equipment Improvement

Characters might be either forced into a situation where they need to craft their own equipment or choose to improve their own equipment to gain an edge.

Crafting items requires at least two things; access to the required components (such as medicinal herbs or mechanical components) and at least 1 level of skill in the relevant skill (for example, Tinkering & Repair). In general, crafting and working with equipment requires a Practical skill. These are:

**Tinkering & Repair:** Used for mechanical systems and apparatus and tools made of primarily solid, non-natural components (such as metals, processed woods, and glasses).

**Survival & Nature Crafting:** Used for emergency crafting with scavenged items and natural components.

Items that can be crafted and improved are typically always ad-hoc and simple, enabled by the availability of components and typically done by hand or via hand tools.

Crafting requires **components**. A component can be either **natural** or **artificial**. Natural components are found in nature. Artificial components are not.

All components are considered to be interchangeable unless they have narrative importance for the scenario.

When a character has a skill level in the appropriate skill, they can attempt to craft an item from the list of Basic Items, excluding components. The number of components required is proportional to the Size of the item.

**Small Item**      2 Components

**Medium Item**    4 Components

**Large Item**      8 Components

Items with a Cost Score of 1 or 2 do not require a check.

For items with a Cost Score of 3 or higher, however, the item is complex enough that failure may occur, and a BS check must be made in order to determine whether the character performing the assembly is successful.

**Cost Score < 5**                      + 0 Complexity

**5 <= Cost Score < 9**              + 1 Complexity

**10 <= Cost Score < 14**            + 2 Complexity

**14 <= Cost Score**                  + 3 Complexity

*Note: it can be seen that most items from the Basic Items list have a cost score that is limited to 10; however, as cost scores can be increased via improvements (which can be included in the item on crafting) the complexity can increase significantly as a result.*

All weapons crafted **in the field** will have at least one **Flaw**. Choose which.

If you choose to add a further **flaw**, the check complexity decreases by 1. You can do this up to 2 times.

If a crafting check fails, components are lost. The amount salvaged equals up to your skill in the crafting ability.

Items that are of the applicable type (weapons and worn equipment) can be crafted with Improvements, as described in the Improvements and Flawed Items section. However, the amount of Improvements that can be added by the Player Character is limited by their skill in the relevant crafting skill. The number of improvements that can be added is equal to their skill level. **Improvements increase the check complexity by +1.**

Crafting an item also takes a significant amount of energy and time. It costs 1 recuperation point to craft an item from scratch.

## Crafting Items in Workshops

As opposed to crafting items in the field, items can instead be crafted in specialised workshops.

**When in a workshop, crafting doesn't cost Recuperation points and Flaws are not automatically added onto crafted equipment. They can be added on to reduce check complexity.**

In addition, instead of using an Intuition skill, the player character can substitute an appropriate Intellect based skill when making the roll.

You can use either **Engineering, Mathematics & Physics** or **Medicine & Biology**, if applicable.

All other rules apply.

## Improving Items

Using the rules above, instead of crafting an item, you can improve a weapon or worn item if you have a level in the relevant skill.

You can add up to **one improvement per your level in your applied skill** to an item on a successful check. Making an improvement to an item costs 2 components.

## 19. Vehicles & Riding

### Vehicles & Riding Overview

Characters won't spend all of their time on their feet. In order to move quickly, a character may take the reins of a mount or grab the wheel of the latest arcanopropelled personal carriage.

### Mounts

When mounted, a mount enables their rider to control their movement and actions whilst they are under its control.

Unless otherwise specified, a creature can only be mounted by another if they are a size category larger than the rider; otherwise, they are unable to move comfortably: their movement speed is halved, and they are unable to be controlled via the Control Mount action as described below.

The mount has its own turn in combat, determined in the normal manner.

**The rider uses their own opportunity points to enable the mount to take opportunities in combat. When the rider uses their opportunity points to allow the mount to take an opportunity, the opportunity point cost is determined based on whether it is the mounts turn, not the riders.**

If the mount is considered under only **partial** control, then the opportunity cost for all actions the rider wants the mount to take is increased by 1.

A mount that is not under any sort of control takes their own opportunities using their own opportunity points as normal. The rider is just sat on them whilst they do it.

### Vehicles

Vehicles have **positions**. Each vehicle position enables the character in that position to use the vehicle in a specific way. In combat, the position a character occupies also determines any additional opportunities they can take (such as firing a mounted gun, or driving the vehicle forwards).

A vehicle cannot operate itself unless it is stated to be **automated**. If a position is automated for the purpose of making checks it is always considered to have statistics of 7 and no skills, unless otherwise stated.

Each **position** can be targeted by other characters and can be damaged as normal; however, as vehicles are typically more resilient than the average person, the severity score of any damage caused to the vehicle as part of an attack is reduced by 1.

Positions work similarly to characters in that they are given a **Damage Threshold** which operates analogously to Injury Thresholds for creatures and characters.

A position becomes non-functional when the Damage Threshold for that position is reached.

Vehicles have **reinforcement**. This operates in a manner analogous to cover (see Cover / Concealment). Every vehicle has at minimum **light reinforcement**, which is analogous to **light cover**. Heavier vehicles will have different degrees of cover, stated in their description. A character inside the vehicle also benefits from cover equivalent to its reinforcement at all times.

## 20. Appendix: Arcane Spellcasting

### Spellcasting

An Arcanothurge can only have one spell of each type active at any given time. Choose a spellcasting type (emission, conjuration, or alteration) and describe the effect you want to happen. The effect you describe must adhere to all limitations, unless a limitation is **lifted**.

#### *Emission Spell:*

An emission spell refers to any spell that involves the creation of elemental energy in order to produce an effect. These spells are frequently explosive and immeasurably damaging in nature; arcanothurges that use emission use them frequently to cast balls of fire, fire lightning from their fingertips, and summon balls of light to illuminate the way.

By default, all Emission spells have the following limitations:

**Type:** The energy type can only be either fire, lightning, cold, or air pressure. If this limitation is lifted, the type of energy can change during the duration of the spell.

**Origin:** The origin of the spell must start in the Caster's hand or in close range (<2 m). If this limitation is removed, the spell can originate from a point within medium distance (50 m). If this limitation is lifted a second time, it can originate from a point within long distance (500 m).

**Travel Distance:** The emitted energy cannot travel from its origin. If this limitation is lifted, the energy can travel from its origin in metres up to a medium distance (50 m). Its trajectory must be a straight line. If this limitation is lifted a second time, it can travel up to a long distance (500 m).

**Size:** The size of the emission can be no larger than half a metre in any dimension. If this limitation is lifted, the emission can be as large in metres as the caster's mind score in any dimension.

**Duration:** The emission will only last until the start of the caster's next turn. If this limitation is lifted, the spell can last until the start of the caster's turn, plus an additional number of rounds equal to Caster's Intellect statistic.

**Number:** The number of emissions can only be 1 as part of this casting. If this limitation is lifted, the number of emissions generated can be up to the caster's Intellect score divided by 2.

**Power:** Depending on the type of emission and a character's exposure to said emission, the maximum amount of damage an emission can deal to a single target is 1 injury point. If this limitation is lifted, the maximum amount of injury points an emission can deal is the number of times this limitation is lifted. This limitation can be lifted more than once.

### *Conjuration Spell:*

Conjuration spells involve summoning items or creatures into existence for a short period of time. At its most basic, this can mean summoning basic materials into being for immediate use; at its most complex, conjuration magic can be used to cleave open the boundaries between worlds and to bring eldritch living creatures into the world.

By default, all Conjuration Spells have the following limitations:

**Type:** The thing being conjured into being must be inanimate. If this limitation is lifted, the thing being conjured can be animated or alive.

**Origin:** The origin of the spell must start in the Caster's hand or in close range (<2 m). If this limitation is removed, the spell can originate from a point within medium distance (50 m). If this limitation is lifted a second time, it can originate from a point within long distance (500 m).

**Size:** The thing being conjured must be no larger than half a metre in any dimension, or small. If this limitation is lifted, the thing being conjured can be up to your Intellect statistic divided by two in metres in any dimension.

**Duration:** The conjuration will only last a number of turns equal to your Mind score, halved, and disappears at the end of your turn. If this limitation is lifted, the spell can last as long in rounds as the Caster's Intellect statistic times 2.

**Number:** The number of conjurations can only be 1. If this limitation is lifted, the number of emissions generated can be up to the caster's Intellect statistic divided by 3.

**Specificity:** The item or creature being conjured cannot be specific. If this limitation is lifted, the thing being summoned can be a specific item or individual. If the thing being summoned is sentient, it can choose to resist being summoned by entering in a Contest, where both you and the creature use their Intellect scores to determine success or failure.

### *Alteration Spell:*

Alteration, as the name implies, means fundamentally changing the properties of things around the caster. This can be used to minor effect to hinder or assist by making things lighter, or by changing the properties of light in the air to create illusions, or to terrifying effect by filling the lungs of creatures with water, or transforming people into frogs.

By default, all Conjuration Spells have the following limitations:

**Type:** The spell cannot alter living matter. If this limitation is lifted, the spell can alter living matter; the target can try to resist the effect by entering a Contest where both you and the target creature use their Intellect scores to determine success or failure.

**Complexity:** The spell can only change one property of a thing at a time (such as density, shape, coloration, hardness, or strength). If this limitation is lifted, the spell can change multiple properties, or change the material entirely.

**Origin:** The Caster must be touching the target of the spell at close range (<2 m) with their hand. If this limitation is removed, the spell can target an item within a short distance (20 m).

**Size:** The target being altered must be no larger than half a metre in any dimension, or small. If this limitation is lifted, the target being altered can be up to your Intellect score divided by 4 in metres.

**Duration:** The transformation will only last until the end of your next turn. If this limitation is lifted, the spell can last as long in turns as the caster's Intellect statistic in rounds.

**Concentration:** Depending on the type of alteration done (if it causes harm to a target), the maximum amount of damage an emission can deal to a single target is 1 injury point. If this limitation is lifted, the maximum amount of injury points an emission can deal is the number of times this limitation is lifted. This limitation can be lifted more than once.

## Lifting Limitations

For every level above 1 you have in the Arcane Spellcasting ability, you can remove a limitation on spell creation (up to 5 limitations).

For every limitation lifted, there is a chance of a misfire. Roll a number of d6 equal to the number of limitations lifted. If two or more of the rolls are 1, a serious misfire occurs; you cannot cast Arcane spells again until you Recuperate.

## Determining Spell Effects

Once a player has outlined what they want their spell to accomplish, it is up to the GM to determine how this is represented in mechanical terms. Under most circumstances, this will result in damage being dealt to a target (a fistful of fire being lobbed at a target is likely to cause severe burns), advantage on some forms of checks being gained or a temporary lever being applied (such as an alteration spell strengthening a creature's muscles granting them the **superhuman strength** lever for the duration, or turning an enemy's armour brittle granting +1 advantage on attack checks against them), or conjuring an item (such as a dagger to use in an emergency). Some spells, however, may be more creative; and may have unpredictable outcomes.

For simplicity, it is recommended to limit the primary outcomes of a spell to up to **two** tangible outcomes. These can then be applied to as many targets as may be applicable based on the spell.

When casting a spell with intent to harm another, harm is almost always guaranteed but degree of harm is not. This is determined by concentration. In instances where harm is not guaranteed (in instances where a target may be protected in some form, or may have biology unique to them that renders them resistant to the spell), checks can be performed as normal to determine outcome.

### *Direct Damage Spells*

Spells that deal damage may either deal damage directly, or may be considered to create a hazard (as per the Hazards & Hazardous Situations rules). In both cases, the damage dealt by the spell is limited as per the spell limitations, or to a severity of 1.

Once such a spell is cast, it is assumed to always have a positive outcome, however factors such as protection or mitigating actions may reduce its effect. For example, if a caster summons a ball of fire on a target, the target **will** be hit by the fire, but by wearing protective equipment that protects against fire specifically may reduce or negate the damage taken.

### *Environmental Damage Spells*

Spells that manipulate or alter the environment in such a way that an already existing hazard causes harm inherit the severity of the hazard.



In general a player will have a significant degree of control regarding the intent of the spell, however even carefully worded spells may have side-effects and consequences that are determined by the GM.

## 21. Appendix: Ideation

### *Ideation Prerequisites*

Upon getting access to the first level in this ability, choose an Ideal. An ideal can be many things, but in order to manifest it in the real world, it is given shape in the form of a physical object; this is called the **Imagined Form**. For example, concepts such as Justice may be given the form of a Scales, or a Sword, whereas the concept of time may be given the form of an Hourglass, a Clock, or Sand.

This object is referred to as your Form; that is to say, the form your ideal takes and manifests as. When you select your Form, you must answer the following three questions:

**Function of the Idea: What does your Ideal enable you to do? In what way does holding this Ideal help you?**

This answer must take the form of a verb (for example: to cut, to illuminate, to cure). The answer may have additional context added to it for the purposes of identifying the mindset of the character, but it is the verb that is retained as the key term that constitutes the Function of the Idea. Answer the question once. For example: ‘My ideal enables me to **protect** others’; ‘My ideal lets me **find** the truth’.

From this statement, the verb is selected as a key term.

**Function of the Form: What function does your Imagined Form have for you?**

This answer must take the form of a verb (for example: to cut, to illuminate, to cure). Answer the question twice, with a different answer each time.

**Antithesis of the Ideal: What defeats your Imagined Form? What concept or circumstance counters your Imagined form for you?**

The answer must take the form of a circumstance, a physical item, or a concept. Up to three nouns are extracted from this answer and constitute the antithesis of the ideal; these are concepts that, when you are exposed to them, render the ideation more difficult.

The answers to these questions are based on your character’s personal interpretation of these concepts. For one character, the function of the form of a sword may be to **cut** or **attack**; to another, it may be to **defend** and **serve**. These answers guide how the manifestation occurs, as well as how complex the ideation of these concepts is.

### *Manifesting Desires*

This ability allows you to attempt to manifest via ideation a powerful spell. You do not have complete control over how the spell will affect the environment, but it is guided by your Ideal and your Form.

In order to use this ability, you must state a specific Desire, as well as vocalise what you perceive to be the primary obstacle to your desire. The Desire is best vocalised in the form of short, direct sentences, and must include at least one verb. The Obstacle is best vocalised in terms of a specific term that can be identified within the immediate situation.

For example:

I want the **door** to **open**; the **lock** is stopping me. (In this case, the door opening is the desire; the lock is identified as the obstacle).

I want to **win the fight**; the enemies are in my way. (In this case, winning the fight is the desire; the enemies are the obstacle).

I want to **find the missing evidence**; the darkness is preventing me. (In this case, finding the evidence is the desire; the darkness is the obstacle.)

You can add conditional terms such as if, whilst, and, or, etc. to the desire statement; however, for each conditional statement used, the complexity level of the subsequent check will be increased by 1. That is to say; simple desires are more easy to manifest than complex ones.

Once the desire has been vocalised, three questions must be answered truthfully.

*Does the desire portion of the vocalisation feature a verb that features in your Function of the Ideal, or is a synonym thereof?*

*Can the obstacle be overcome using one or more of the verbs (or synonyms thereof) stated in the Function of the Form?*

*Are there no aspects of the situation you are in that contain the terms or synonyms thereof from the Antithesis of the Ideal?*

For every 'no' answered in response to these three questions, the subsequent check is done at -1 disadvantage.

Once all questions are answered, a BS check determines the success of the manifestation. All disadvantages and complexities determined using the methods above are included in this check. You gain a bonus to this check equal to your level in this ability.

### *Determining Ideation Effects*

If the check passes, the GM determines how best to action this desire. The GM may choose one of the following effects, or invent their own if a more suitable alternative presents itself naturally.

- Apply a Hazard to the immediate environment. In combat, the Hazard will manifest within a range of the character up to their Mind score times their level in this ability.
- Grant +1 advantage on checks relevant to the desire to all applicable characters.
- Select a target and inflict (or restore) a number of injury points equal to to the character's level in this ability.
- Alter one aspect of the immediate environment. This may be temporarily causing a creature or obstacle to vanish, creating a bridge, render a clue or environmental detail painfully obvious, or remove a hazard from the environment.

The manifestation of the desire lasts for a number of rounds of combat equal to 1 + the character's level in this ability. Out of combat, it lasts for a short duration, as using ideation to manifest alterations in the physical world is mentally taxing. Where an ability has an immediate effect (such as inflicting an injury), it can be repeated by the use of an Opportunity.

## 22. Appendix: Basic Weapons

### CQC Weapons Examples

**Knife:** One-handed, Weak, **Concealed Weapon** lever

**Sabre:** One-handed, Cutting

**Smallsword:** One-handed, Agile

**Flamberge:** Two-handed, Cutting

**Mace:** One-handed, Anti-Armour

**Pole-hammer:** Two-handed, Anti-Armour

### Ranged Weapons Examples

**Derringer:** One-handed, Short Range, Weak, **Concealed Weapon** lever

**Pistol:** One-handed, Medium Range

**Rifle:** Two-handed, Long Range

**Shotgun:** Two-handed, Medium Range

**Sharpshooter Rifle:** Two-handed, Long Range, **Sniper** lever

## 23. Appendix: Sample SNPCs

|                           |                                                      |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Soldier</b>                                       |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Basic                                                |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Strength (+2)                                        |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Mobile Fighter</b>                                |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Sabre (One-handed, Cutting)<br>Light Armour<br>Rifle |

|                           |                                                          |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Special Forces</b>                                    |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Elite                                                    |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Strength (+3)                                            |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Mobile Fighter</b>                                    |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Flamberge (Two-handed, Cutting)<br>Light Armour<br>Rifle |

|                           |                                               |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Marksman</b>                               |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Elite                                         |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Finesse (+3)                                  |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Sniper</b>                                 |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Sabre (One-handed, Cutting)<br>Marksman Rifle |

|                           |                                                       |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Arcanothurge</b>                                   |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Elite                                                 |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Intellect (+3)                                        |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Arcane Spellcasting (2)</b>                        |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Knife (One-handed, Cutting)<br>Light Armour<br>Pistol |

|                           |                                                       |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Officer</b>                                        |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Elite                                                 |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Intuition (+3)                                        |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Take Cover!</b>                                    |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Sabre (One-handed, Cutting)<br>Heavy Armour<br>Pistol |

|              |                  |
|--------------|------------------|
| <b>Name:</b> | <b>Clawbeast</b> |
| <b>Tier:</b> | Basic            |

|                           |                                                            |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Strength (+2)                                              |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Mobile Fighter</b>                                      |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Claws (One-handed, Cutting)<br>Claws (One-handed, Cutting) |

|                           |                                                          |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Wingbeast</b>                                         |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Basic                                                    |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Strength (Finesse)                                       |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Adaptation (Wings)</b>                                |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Talons (One-handed, Agile)<br>Talons (One-handed, Agile) |

|                           |                   |
|---------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Biterbeast</b> |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Basic             |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Strength (+2)     |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Manslayer</b>  |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Jaw (Two-handed)  |

|                           |                                                            |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Hunterbeast</b>                                         |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Elite                                                      |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Strength (+3)                                              |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Mobile Fighter</b>                                      |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Claws (One-handed, Cutting)<br>Claws (One-handed, Cutting) |

|                           |                                                          |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name:</b>              | <b>Stalkerbeast</b>                                      |
| <b>Tier:</b>              | Elite                                                    |
| <b>Primary Statistic:</b> | Finesse (+3)                                             |
| <b>Ability:</b>           | <b>Stealth Attack</b>                                    |
| <b>Loadout:</b>           | Talons (One-handed, Agile)<br>Talons (One-handed, Agile) |

## 24. Appendix: Abomination Cores

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Wrack</b>          | <p>The Abomination selects a target it can sense in the scene. The target does not gain Opportunities at the start of its turn, and every time it tries to take an Opportunity, they must roll a BS check to overcome the pain. If they succeed they can take the opportunity, but also gain 1 injury point. If they fail, they cannot take the Opportunity.</p> <p>This effect lasts until the end of the Abomination's next turn.</p> |
| <b>Paralyse</b>       | <p>The Abomination selects a target it can sense in the scene. The target cannot take opportunities until the end of the Abomination's next turn.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Execute</b>        | <p>The Abomination selects a target within close range of their Core. The GM flips a coin. On heads, the target takes an injury point. On tails, they gain an 1d6 injury points.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Toxic Cloud</b>    | <p>The GM rolls a BF check for every player character within a short distance of all of the Abomination's cores.</p> <p>If the characters are not immune to poisonous substances or toxins, on a failure they may either hold their breath or otherwise protect themselves from the poison using an Opportunity or they take an injury point from the poison.</p>                                                                       |
| <b>Toxic Spray</b>    | <p>The Abomination makes an attack against 3 targets it can sense. On a hit, if the characters are not immune to poisonous substances, they can choose to lose either 1d6 Opportunity Points, or take an injury point.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Cast Web</b>       | <p>The GM rolls a BF check for every player medium range of the Core.</p> <p>On a failure, the character's speed is reduced to 0 and they do not gain an Opportunity point at the start of their turn until the end of the Abomination's next turn,</p>                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Burst of Speed</b> | <p>The abomination moves up to a medium distance (50 m) and until the end of its next attacks made against it are made at -1 disadvantage.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Charge</b>         | <p>The abomination moves its core to a medium distance (50 m) towards a target.</p> <p>If the target is within Reach at the end of this movement, it deals a number of injury points to the target equal to the abomination's Tier, and knocks the target prone.</p>                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Obliterate</b>     | <p>The abomination selects a target within the scene it can sense. The GM flips a coin; on heads, the target takes an injury point. On tails, the target takes 1d6 injury points. Until the end of the abomination's next turn, the target has -1 disadvantage on all ranged attacks as a cloud of dust or smoke from the attack renders visibility difficult.</p>                                                                      |
| <b>Barrage</b>        | <p>The abomination selects a target within the scene it can sense and makes an attack. On a hit, it deals an injury point, and then makes another attack against a different character with -1 modifier. The abomination can repeat this attack until it misses, adding -1 to the modifier on each subsequent target (to a maximum of -5), or until it runs out of new targets.</p>                                                     |

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Alter Perception</b> | <p>The abomination selects a target within the scene and chooses one of the following effects; it either grants itself complete concealment against the target, or switches its perceived position with a different character.</p> <p>Unless the target chooses to and successfully passes a BS check using their Intuition, the next successful attack or effect they make will be applied to a separate target of the abomination's choosing. The target must be capable of physically making the attack or effect against the other target for this effect to work.</p> |
| <b>Alter Position</b>   | The Abomination can either alter its location to anywhere within the scene, or choose to alter the position of any target it can sense within the scene if they fail a BF check.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Electrify Area</b>   | Every character in the scene is exposed to an Energy hazard until the end of the Abomination's next turn.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Energy Arc</b>       | The Abomination makes an attack against either a target it chooses within the scene, or any number of targets exposed to an Energy hazard. On a hit, the target(s) take an injury point.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Hunker Down,</b>     | The Abomination's cores gain the benefits of Medium Cover until the end of the following round.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Knock Back</b>       | The abomination selects a target within Reach. The target is knocked back a short distance (20 m) and is knocked prone. The GM flips a coin; on heads, the target also takes an injury point and has their Opportunity points reduced by 2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Take Flight</b>      | The Abomination flies up to a medium distance (50 m) and can remain in flight until the end of its next turn.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Wing Blast</b>       | Every creature within the Abomination's Reach must pass a BF check or become knocked prone, take 1 injury point and have their Opportunity points reduced by 2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Cone Breath</b>      | <p>The abomination targets every creature in a direction in front of it in a 180° arc present in the scene and makes an attack against each. Cover and concealment are ineffective against this attack.</p> <p>The attack is made using an energy type such as fire, cold, toxins, energy, or pressure. If the target has resistance of any kind to the energy type, the attack has -1 disadvantage. If they are immune, it fails.</p> <p>On a hit, the target takes 1d6 injury points.</p>                                                                                |
| <b>Sweep</b>            | The abomination deals up to 2d6 injury points worth of damage in total, distributed clockwise or anticlockwise from an initial target before moving to the next target. Each target must be within close range (2 metres) of the Core using this ability. Each target takes up to 3 injury points, and then the next target is selected.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Overwhelm</b>        | The Abomination selects a target and overwhelms them. The target is knocked prone and loses 1d6 Opportunity Points and takes an injury point.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Target</b>           | The Abomination targets a creature it can sense within the scene. The GM flips a coin. On heads, the target gains an injury point. On tails, they gain 1d6 injury points.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |



|                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Regenerate</b>      | A core of the Abomination's choosing loses 1d6 injury points.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Expel Toxin</b>     | Every character within Reach of the abomination is exposed to a Poison hazard until the end of the Abomination's next turn.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Go Beyond</b>       | One of the Abomination's cores loses an injury point. Characters within Reach of any of the Abomination's cores are exposed to a Heat hazard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Leech Life</b>      | The Abomination selects a target within close range (2 m) and makes an attack. On a hit, the target gains 1d3 injury points. The Abomination loses the same amount of injury points.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Shrug Off</b>       | The next attack that succeeds against the Abomination is ignored, and until the end of the Abominations next turn, the Abomination gains +1 advantage on attacks against the creature that made the attack.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Lash Out</b>        | <p>Attacks against the Abomination get +1 advantage until the end of the Abomination's next turn. If the Abomination gains an injury point during this time, it can immediately retaliate against the one who injured it, or a character within reach otherwise. The target of this retaliation.</p> <p>The GM flips a coin; on heads, the target of this retaliation takes 1 injury point. On tails, they take a number of injury points equal to the abomination's Tier +1.</p> |
| <b>Protective Aura</b> | The Abomination gains level 1 concealment until the end of their next turn.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Arcane Eruption</b> | Every character within the scene is exposed to an Energy hazard. When a character attempts to perform either arcane spellcasting or ideation, flip a coin. On heads, the casting fails and nothing happens. This effect lasts until the end of the Abominations next turn.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Supercharge</b>     | The next Opportunity the Abomination takes that requires a check is automatically resolved in favour of the Abomination and deals the maximum amount of damage. In addition, all creatures within Reach are exposed to an Energy hazard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## 25. Appendix: Full List of Levers

- |                              |                          |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. Agility                   | 38. Loyalty              |
| 2. Aim                       | 39. Luck                 |
| 3. Allure                    | 40. Mobility             |
| 4. Ambition                  | 41. Momentum             |
| 5. Background                | 42. Mysticism            |
| 6. Bond                      | 43. Perception           |
| 7. Bravery                   | 44. Personality          |
| 8. Bulk                      | 45. Position             |
| 9. Charm                     | 46. Power                |
| 10. Control                  | 47. Psionics             |
| 11. Courage                  | 48. Rage                 |
| 12. Creativity               | 49. Reason               |
| 13. Cunning                  | 50. Reputation           |
| 14. Daring                   | 51. Resilience           |
| 15. Determination            | 52. Ruthlessness         |
| 16. Dimensional Knowledge    | 53. Savagery             |
| 17. Divine Favour            | 54. Silent Movement      |
| 18. Education                | 55. Specialist Knowledge |
| 19. Eldritch Power           | 56. Speechcraft          |
| 20. Energy                   | 57. Speed                |
| 21. Ethereal Sight           | 58. Stamina              |
| 22. Fight or Flight Instinct | 59. Strategy             |
| 23. Financial Skills         | 60. Strength             |
| 24. Focus                    | 61. Superhuman Finesse   |
| 25. Grit                     | 62. Superhuman Intellect |
| 26. Heroism                  | 63. Superhuman Intuition |
| 27. Hunting Experience       | 64. Superhuman Strength  |
| 28. Idealism                 | 65. Survival Experience  |
| 29. Illusion                 | 66. Survival Instincts   |
| 30. Influence                | 67. Teamwork             |
| 31. Initiative               | 68. Training             |
| 32. Insight                  | 69. Trickery             |
| 33. Inspirational Presence   | 70. Truesight            |
| 34. Instincts                | 71. Use of Tools         |
| 35. Keen Eyes                | 72. Wisdom               |
| 36. Killer Instinct          | 73. Wit                  |
| 37. Leadership               | 74. zzz                  |

## 26. Appendix: Example Character Sheet

|                                                                                                     |               |                                 |               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Name:</b><br><b>Level:</b><br><b>Nature:</b><br><b>Class:</b>                                    |               |                                 |               |
| <b>Injury Points:</b>                                                                               |               | <b>Recuperation Points:</b>     |               |
| <b>Injury Threshold:</b>                                                                            |               | <b>Max. Opportunity Points:</b> |               |
| <b>Fortune Points:</b>                                                                              |               | <b>Motivations:</b>             |               |
| <b>Fate Points:</b>                                                                                 |               |                                 |               |
| <b>STATISTICS:</b>                                                                                  |               | <b>SKILLS:</b>                  |               |
|                                                                                                     | <b>Score:</b> | <b>Modifier:</b>                | <b>Score:</b> |
| <b>Statistics:</b><br><b>Strength:</b><br><b>Finesse:</b><br><b>Intuition:</b><br><b>Intellect:</b> |               |                                 |               |
| <b>Nature Traits:</b>                                                                               |               | <b>Abilities:</b>               |               |
| <b>Background Talents:</b>                                                                          |               |                                 |               |
| <b>Inventory:</b>                                                                                   |               | <b>Levers:</b>                  |               |
|                                                                                                     |               |                                 |               |